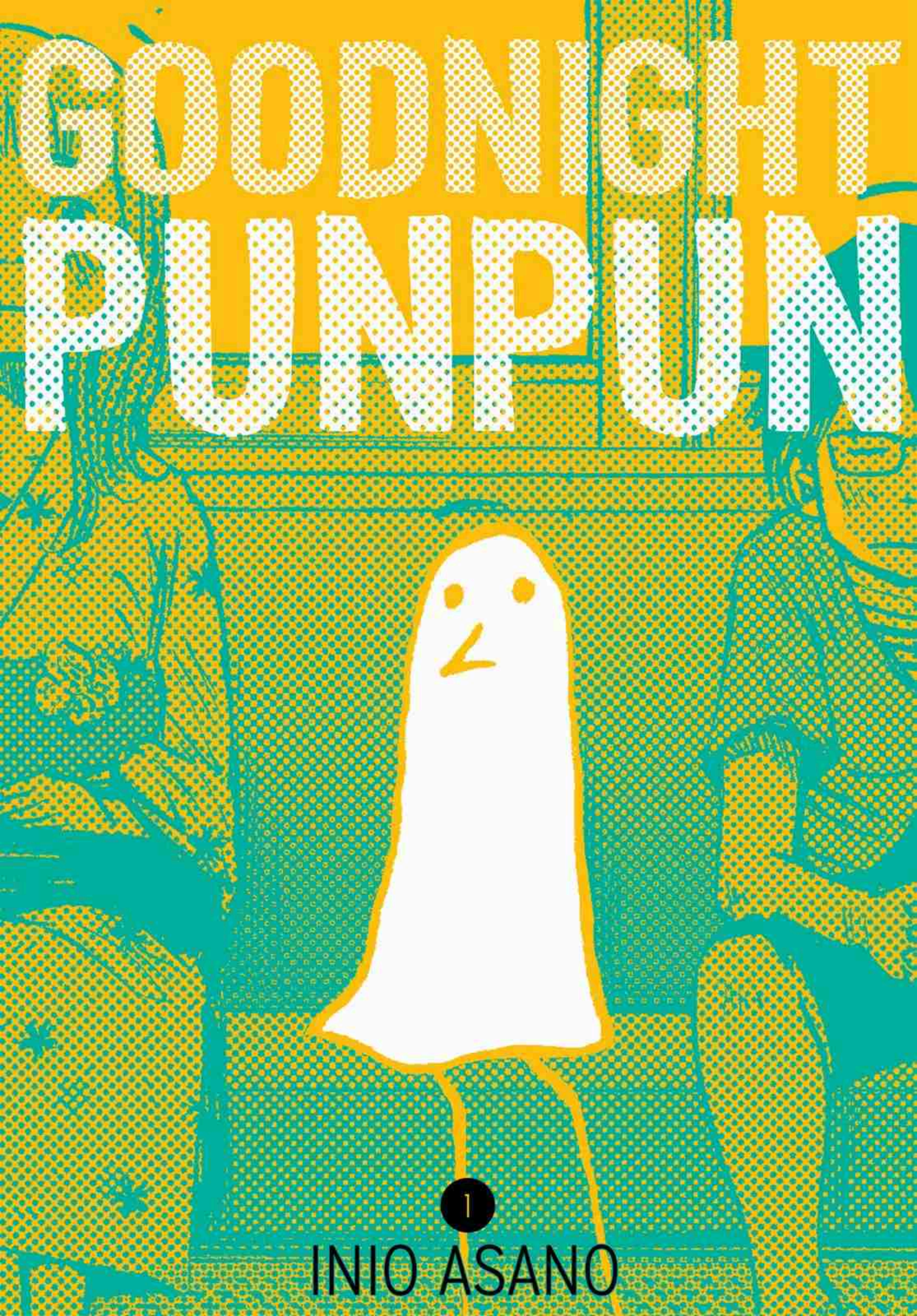

GOODNIGHT
PUNPUN
1
INIO ASANO

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Chapter 7 121

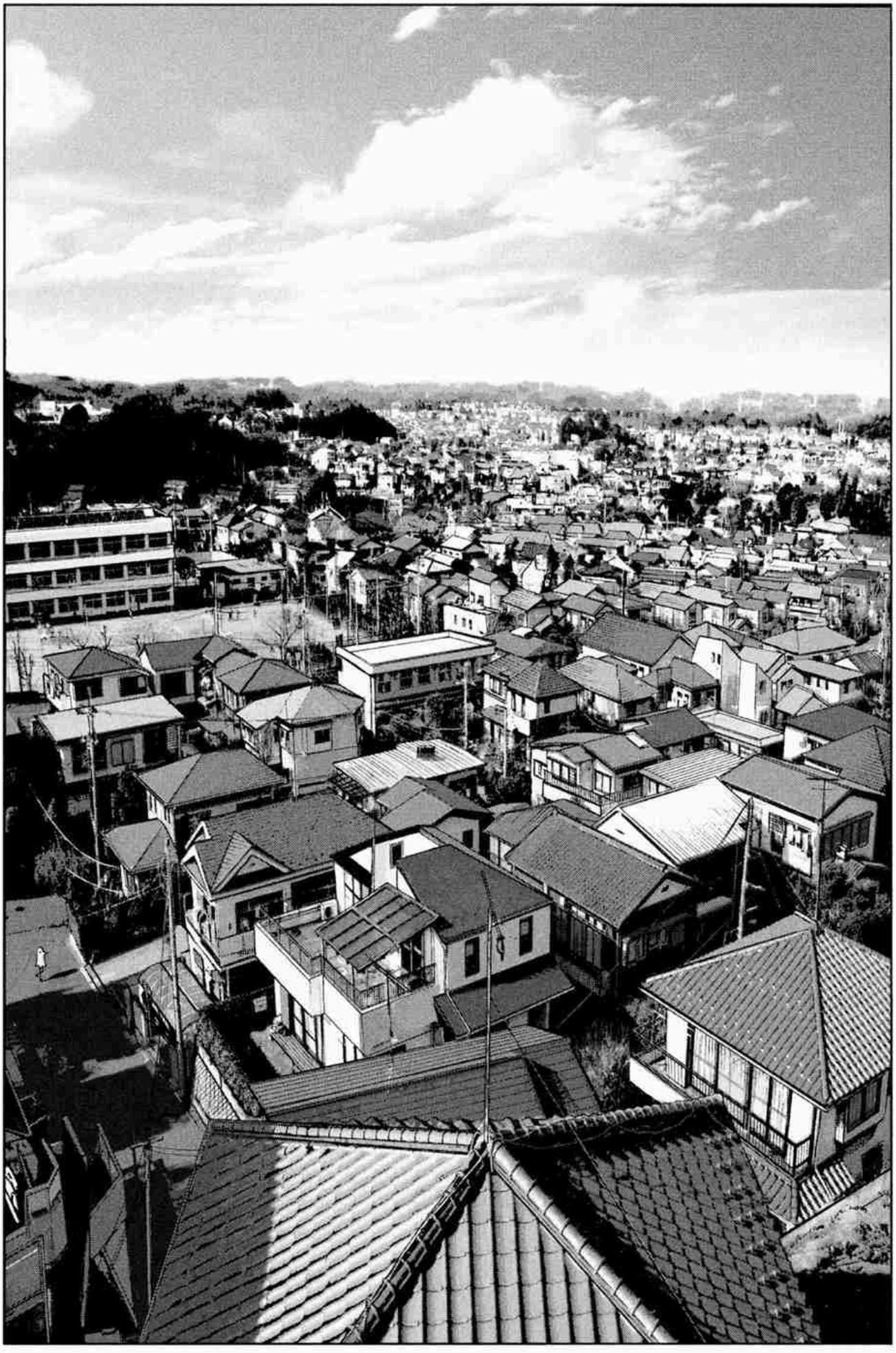
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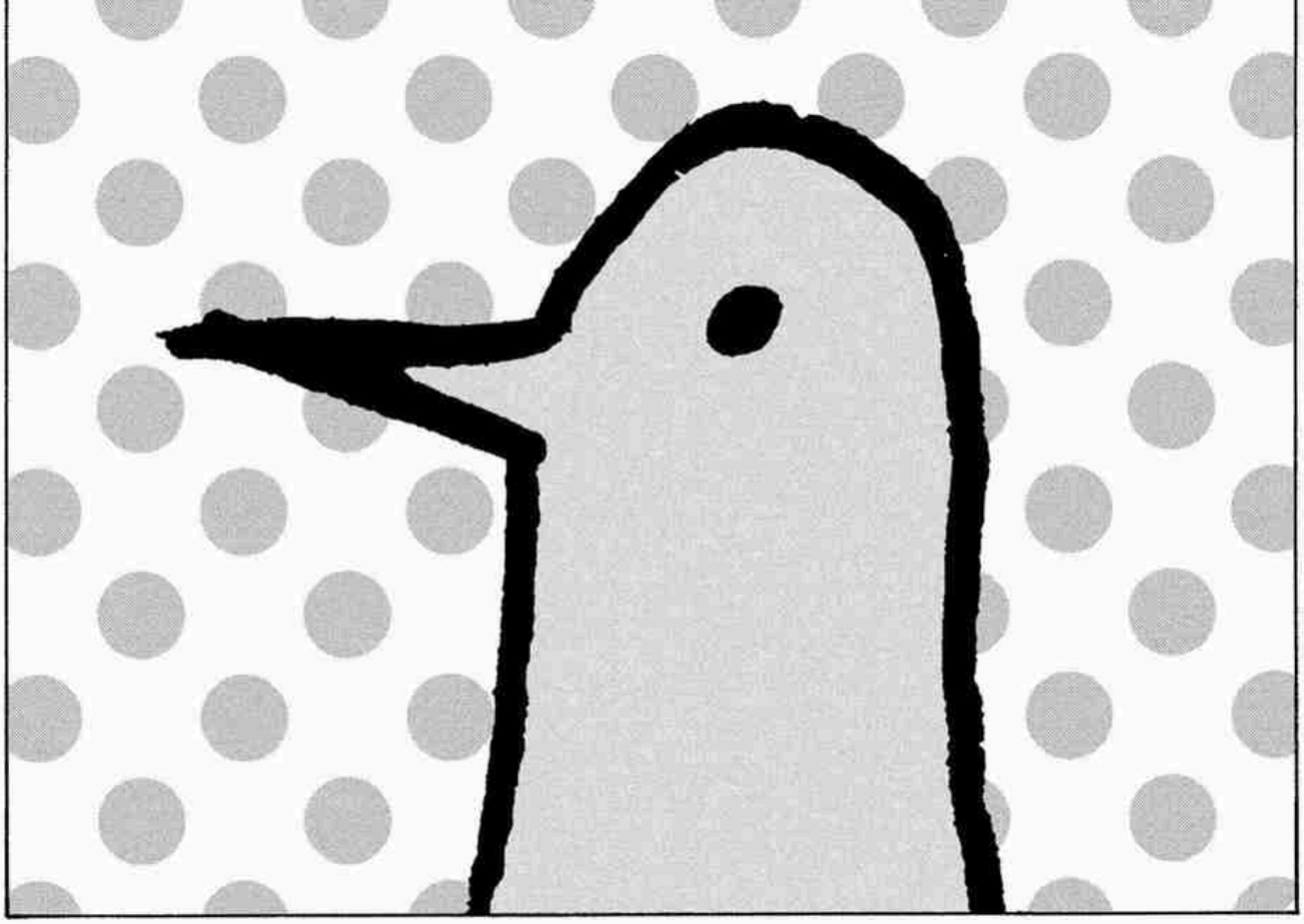
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Chapter 1



Today, Punpun was terribly depressed about going to school...







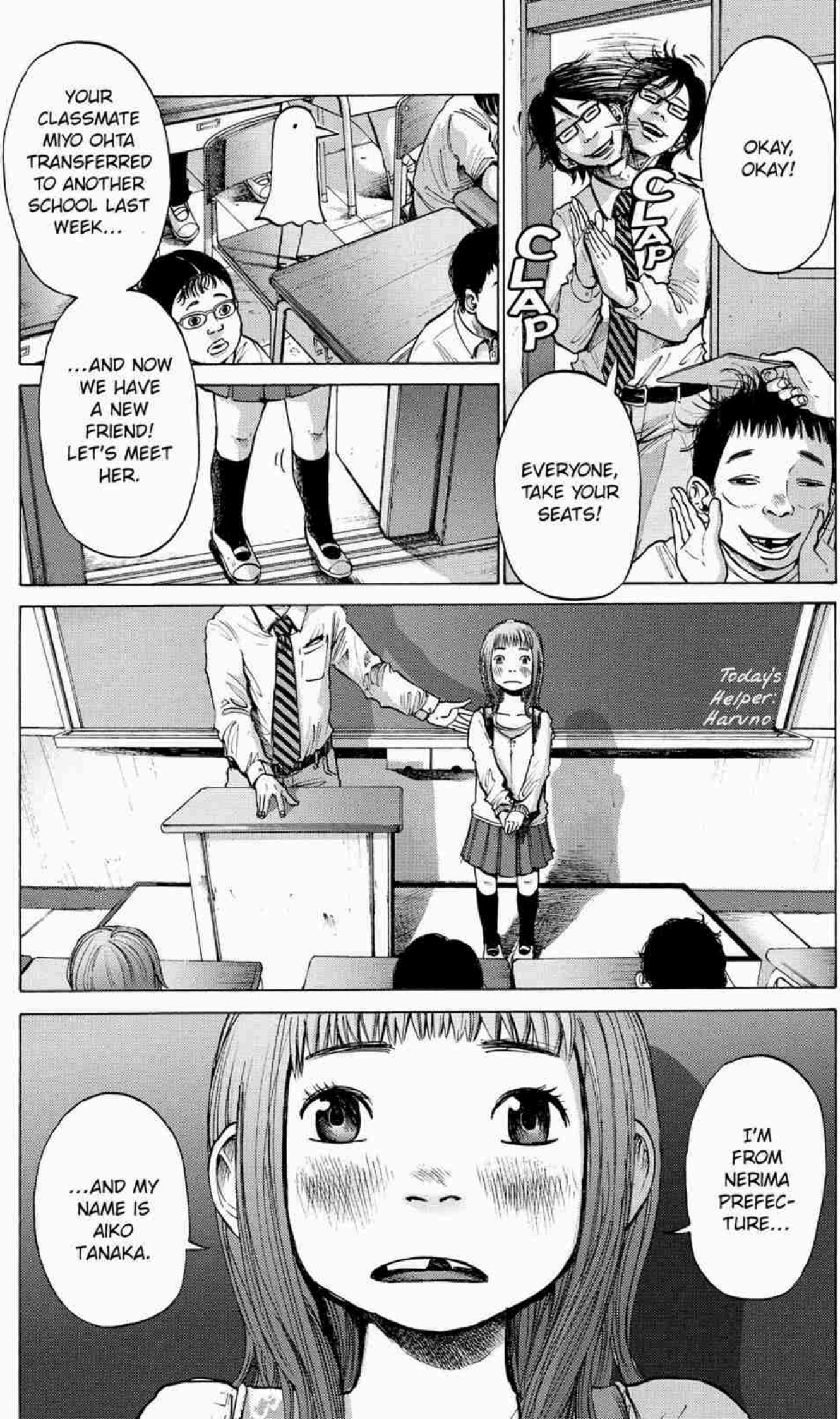
Punpun's earliest memory of Miyo was from a year ago.

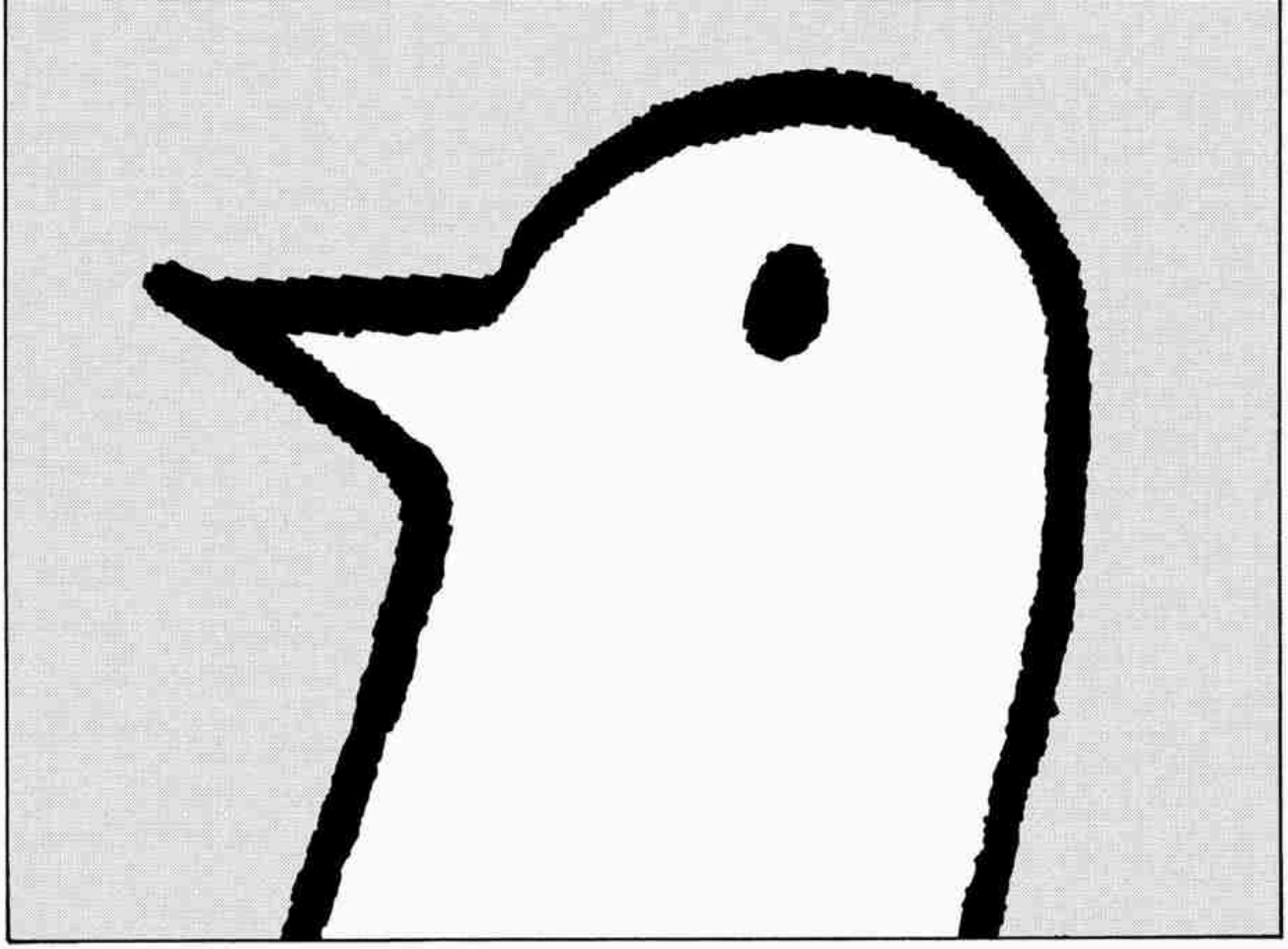
On his way home from school, he saw her shoving pebbles into the mouth of Yoshikawa, the constant target of bullies.

This is the only time I'll mention it, but Punpun had a crush on Miyo.



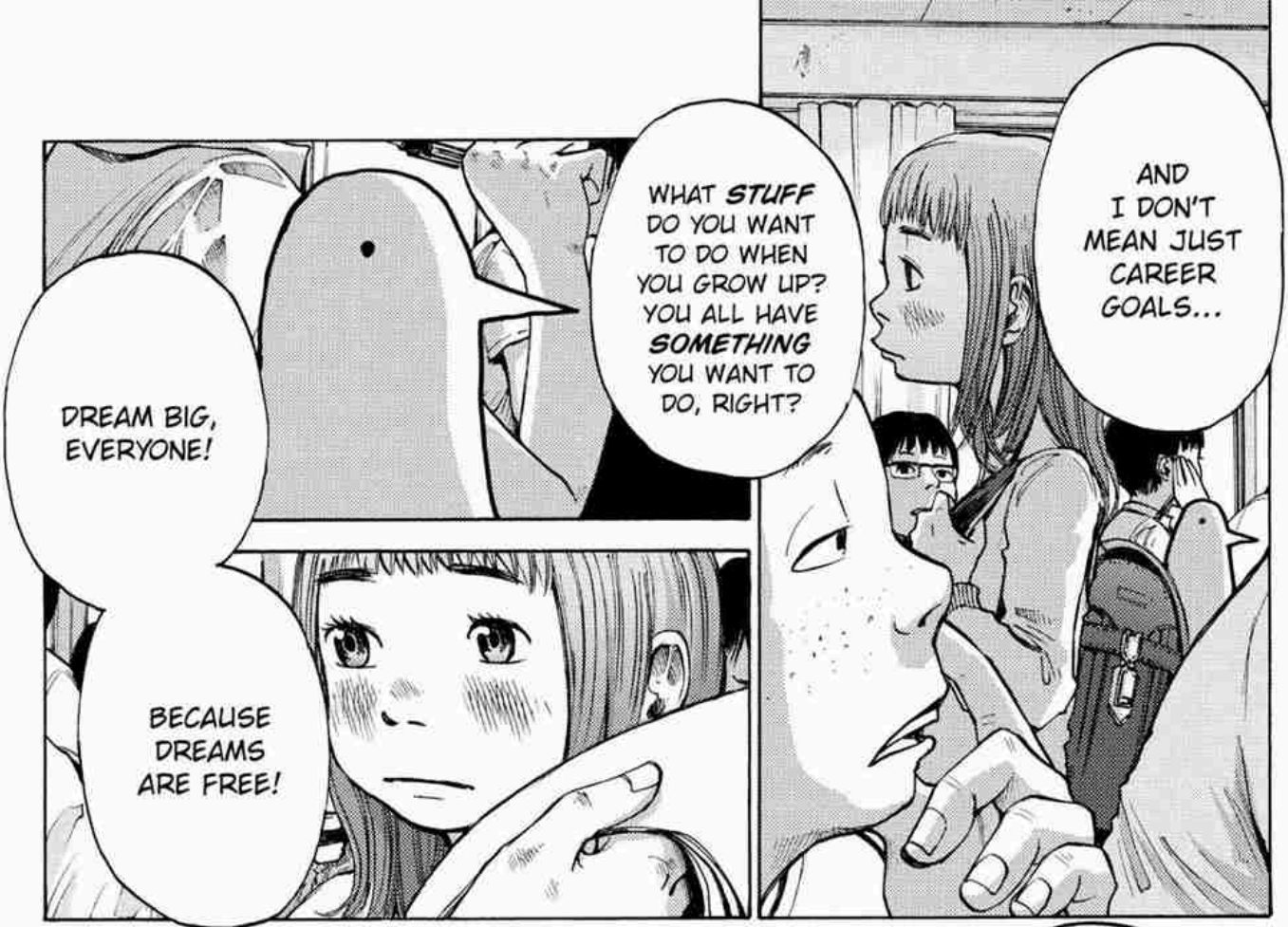

Monday without Miyo would be unbearably boring!
HEY, DO YOU GUYS KNOW ABOUT SEX?
WHAT? DID YOU JUST SAY SEX?!
SHH! NOT SO LOUD!
I'M NOT TELLING YOU, KOMATSU!
PUNPUN, DO YOU KNOW...?
SEE...
...A BOY PUTS HIS THING IN HIS GIRLFRIEND'S THING...
DON'T LOOK SO SHOCKED.

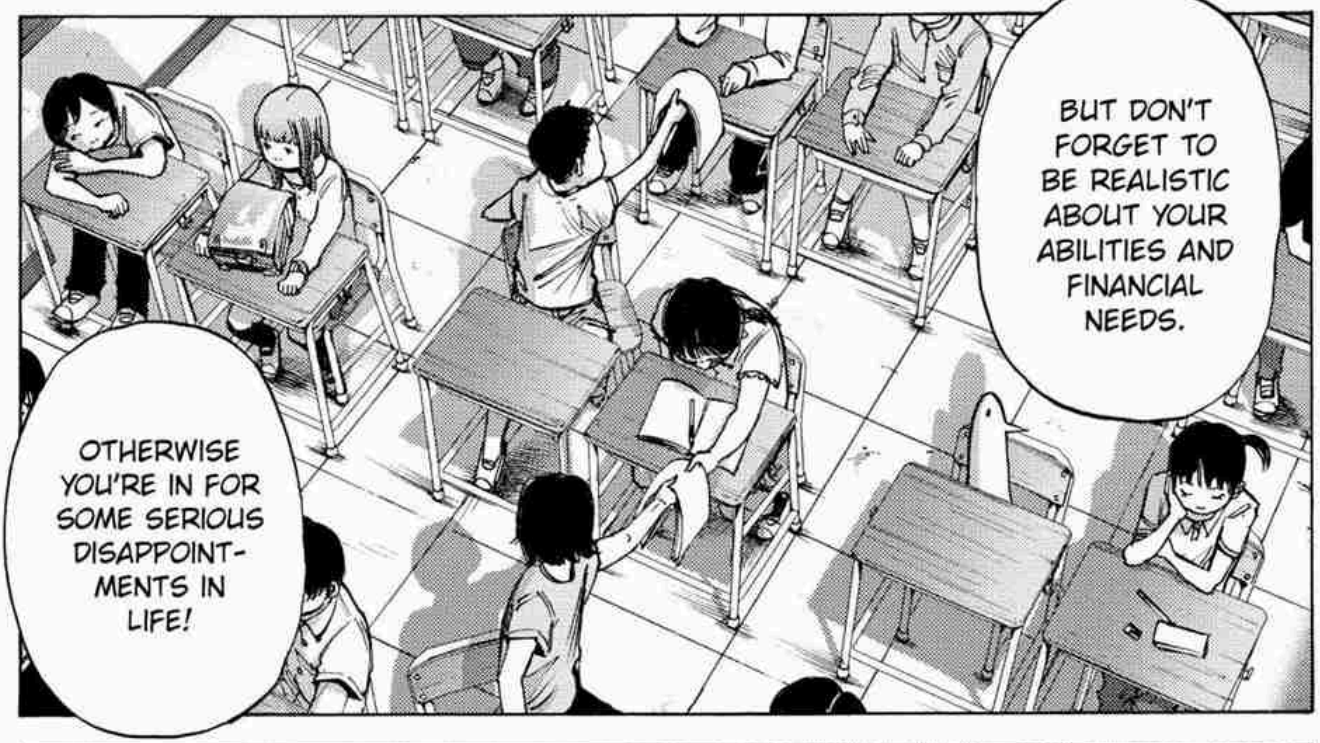

EVERYONE, TAKE YOUR SEATS!
CLAP
CLAP
OKAY, OKAY!
...AND NOW WE HAVE A NEW FRIEND! LET'S MEET HER.
YOUR CLASSMATE MIYO OHTA TRANSFERRED TO ANOTHER SCHOOL LAST WEEK...
Today's Helper: Haruno
I'M FROM NERIMA PREFEC-TURE...
...AND MY NAME IS AIKO TANAKA.



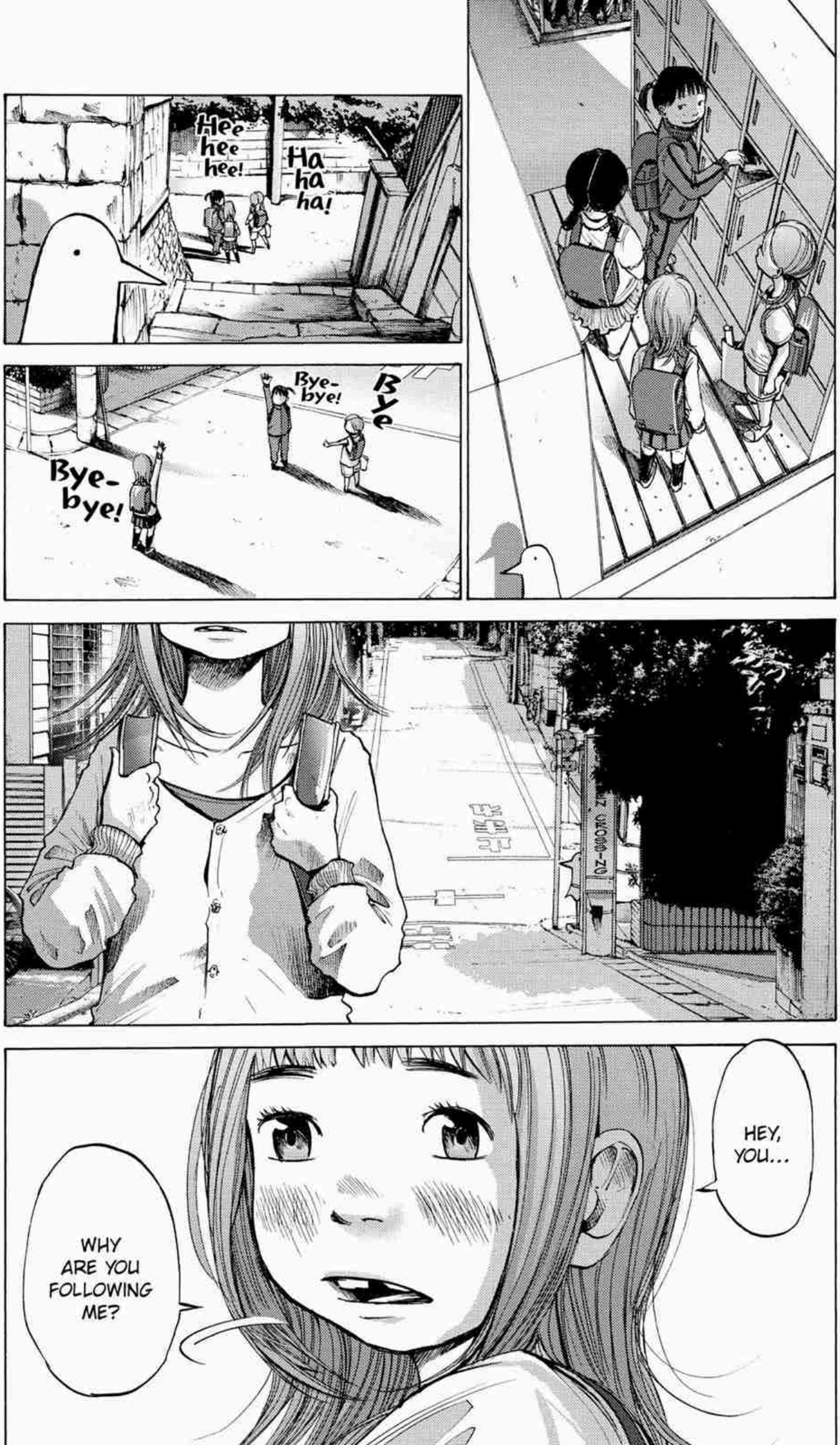
It was love at first sight.

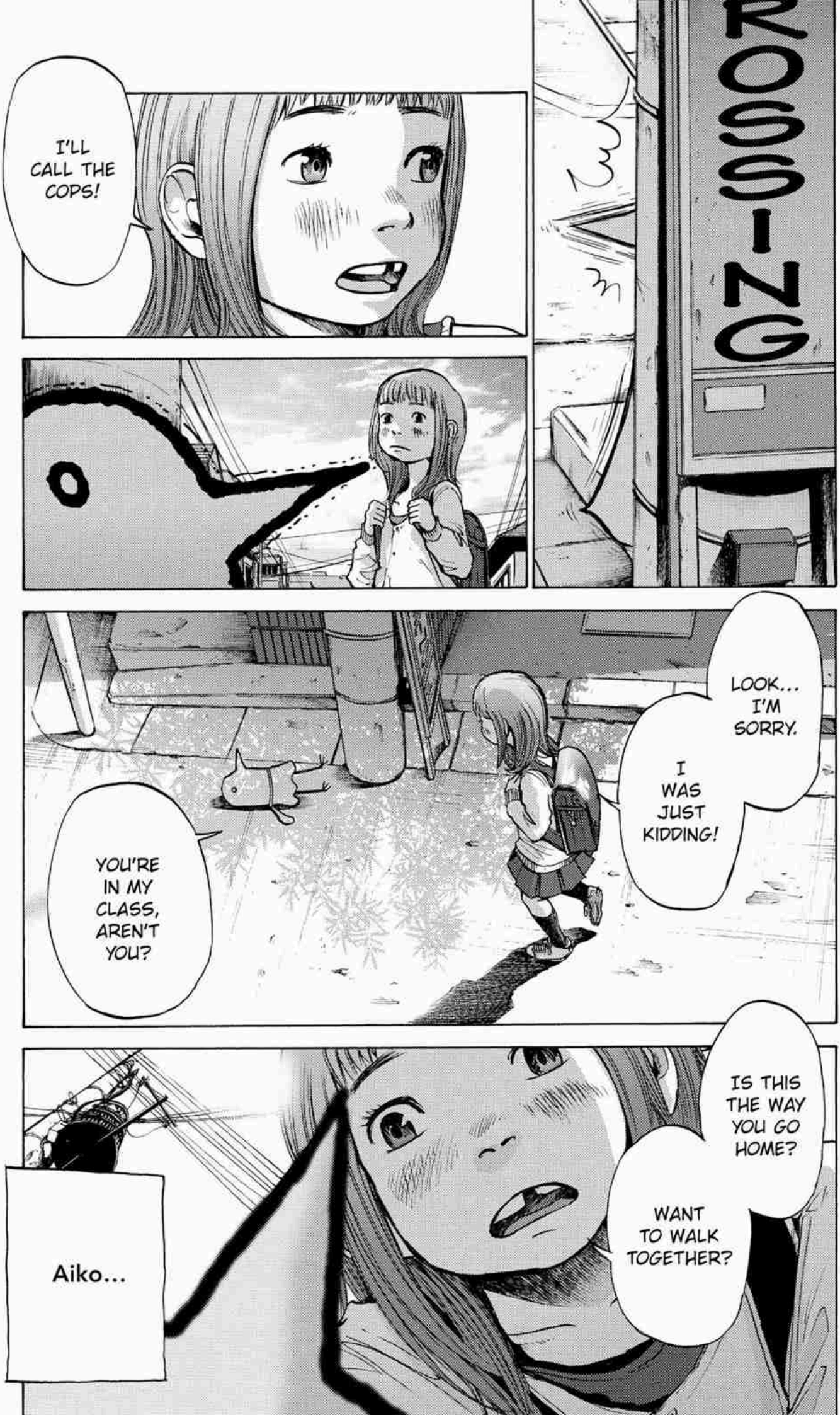



AND I DON'T MEAN JUST CAREER GOALS...
WHAT *STUFF* DO YOU WANT TO DO WHEN YOU GROW UP? YOU ALL HAVE *SOMETHING* YOU WANT TO DO, RIGHT?
DREAM BIG, EVERYONE!
BECAUSE DREAMS ARE FREE!

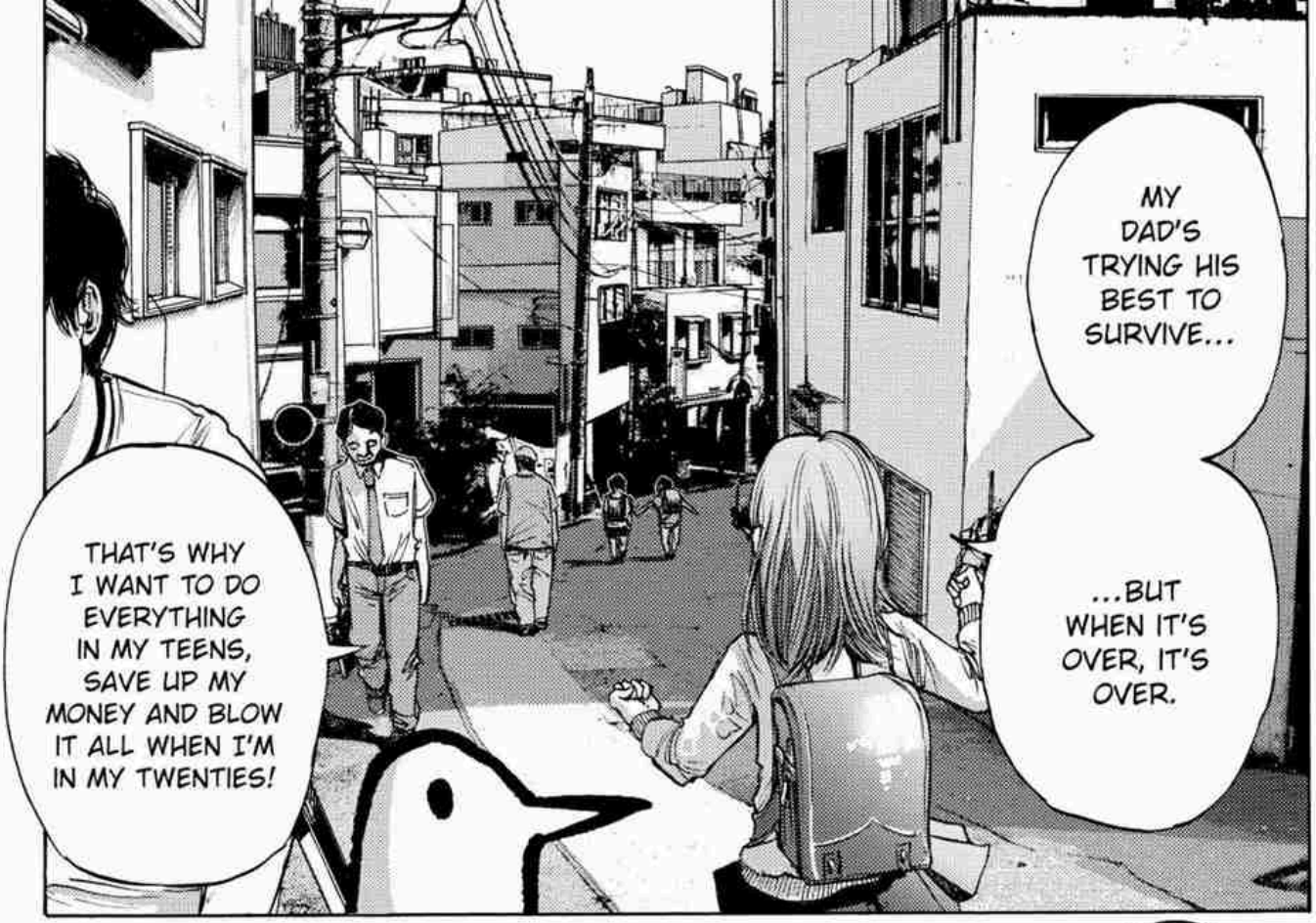

BUT DON'T FORGET TO BE REALISTIC ABOUT YOUR ABILITIES AND FINANCIAL NEEDS.
OTHERWISE YOU'RE IN FOR SOME SERIOUS DISAPPOINT-MENTS IN LIFE!

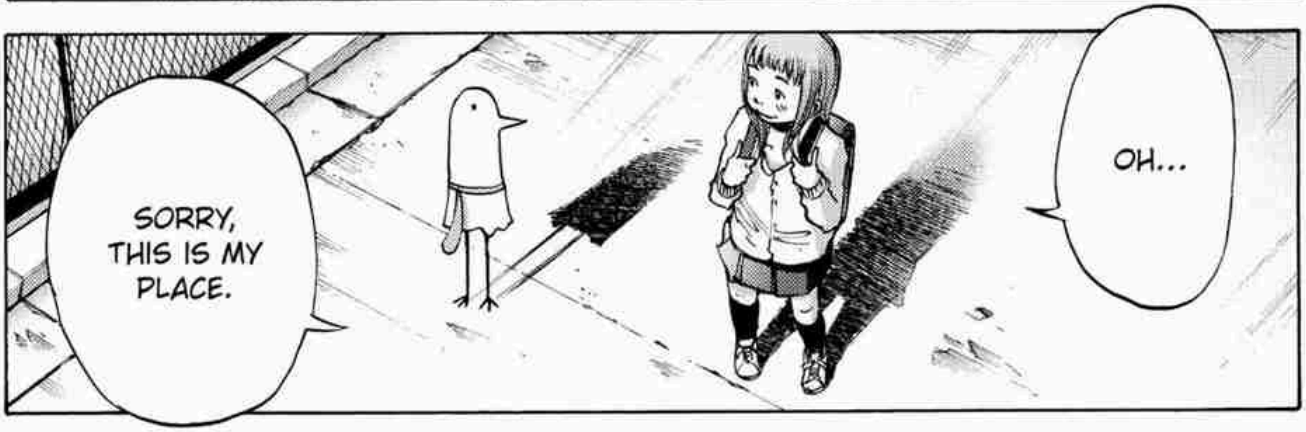

BING
BONG
BING
BONG


Hee hee hee!
Ha ha ha!
Bye-bye!
Bye
Bye-bye!
HEY, YOU...
WHY ARE YOU FOLLOWING ME?


I'LL CALL THE COPS!
ROSSING
LOOK... I'M SORRY.
I WAS JUST KIDDING!
YOU'RE IN MY CLASS, AREN'T YOU?
IS THIS THE WAY YOU GO HOME?
WANT TO WALK TOGETHER?
Aiko...

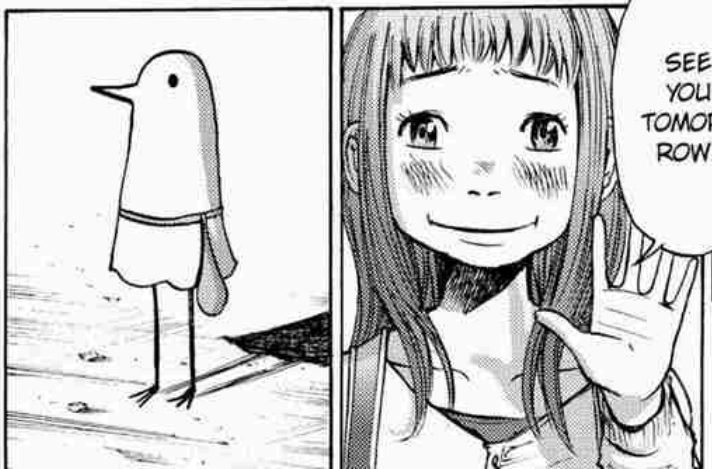

...smelled very nice.
DID YOU FINISH YOUR ESSAY, PUNPUN?
I FINISHED MINE LIKE *THAT*!
BECAUSE I'M GOING TO BE AN ACTRESS, A SINGER OR A MODEL!
HEY, DID YOU KNOW...
...IN A FEW YEARS WE'LL RUN OUT OF OIL, THE ENVIRONMENT WILL BE DESTROYED AND EARTH WILL BE UNINHABITABLE?
UNLESS WE ALL MOVE TO ANOTHER PLANET, IT'LL BE OVER FOR HUMANITY.
DID YOU KNOW THAT?!

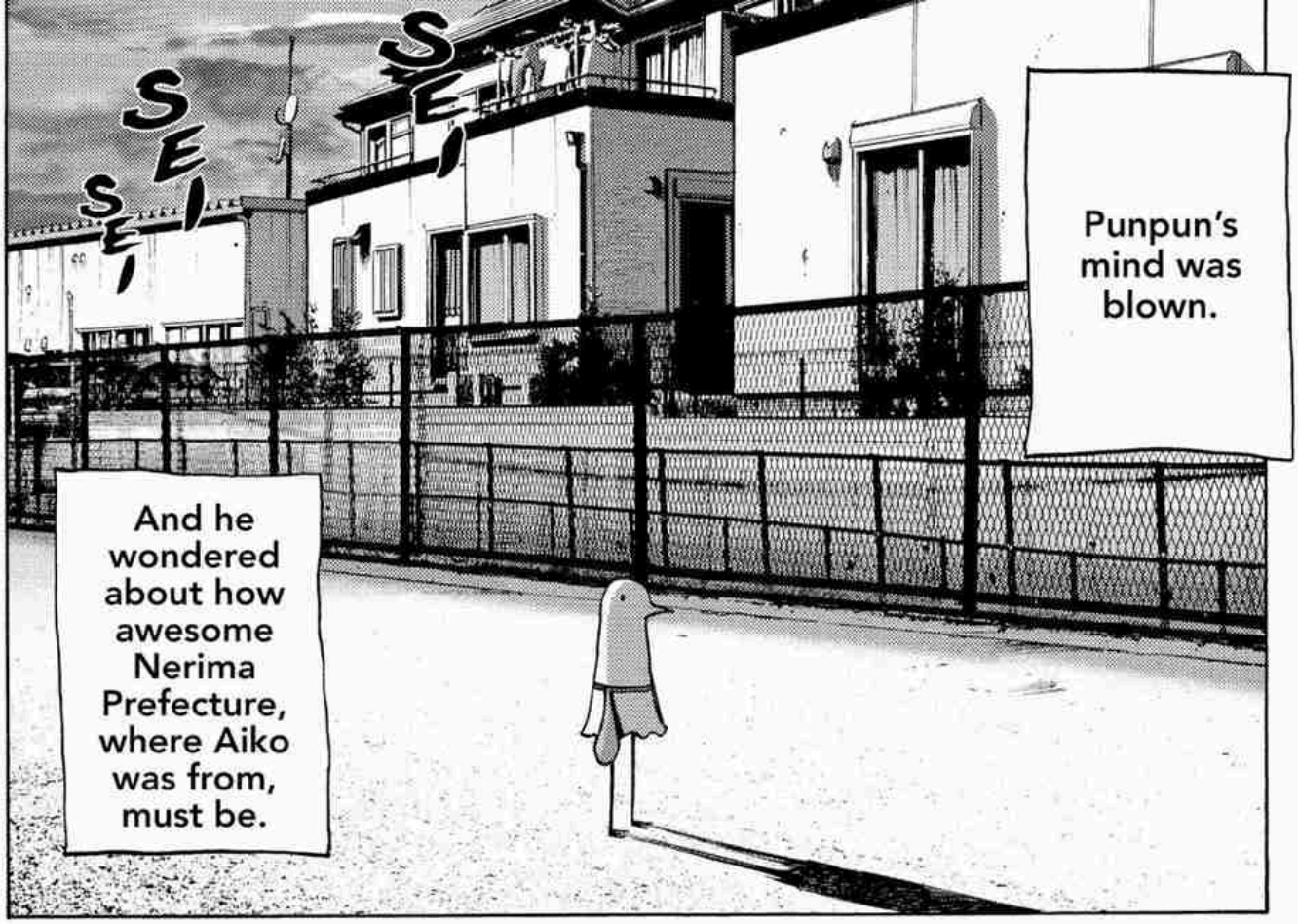

MY DAD'S TRYING HIS BEST TO SURVIVE...
...BUT WHEN IT'S OVER, IT'S OVER.
THAT'S WHY I WANT TO DO EVERYTHING IN MY TEENS, SAVE UP MY MONEY AND BLOW IT ALL WHEN I'M IN MY TWENTIES!


OH...
SORRY, THIS IS MY PLACE.


SEI
SEI
SEI
NEW MEMBERS WANTED

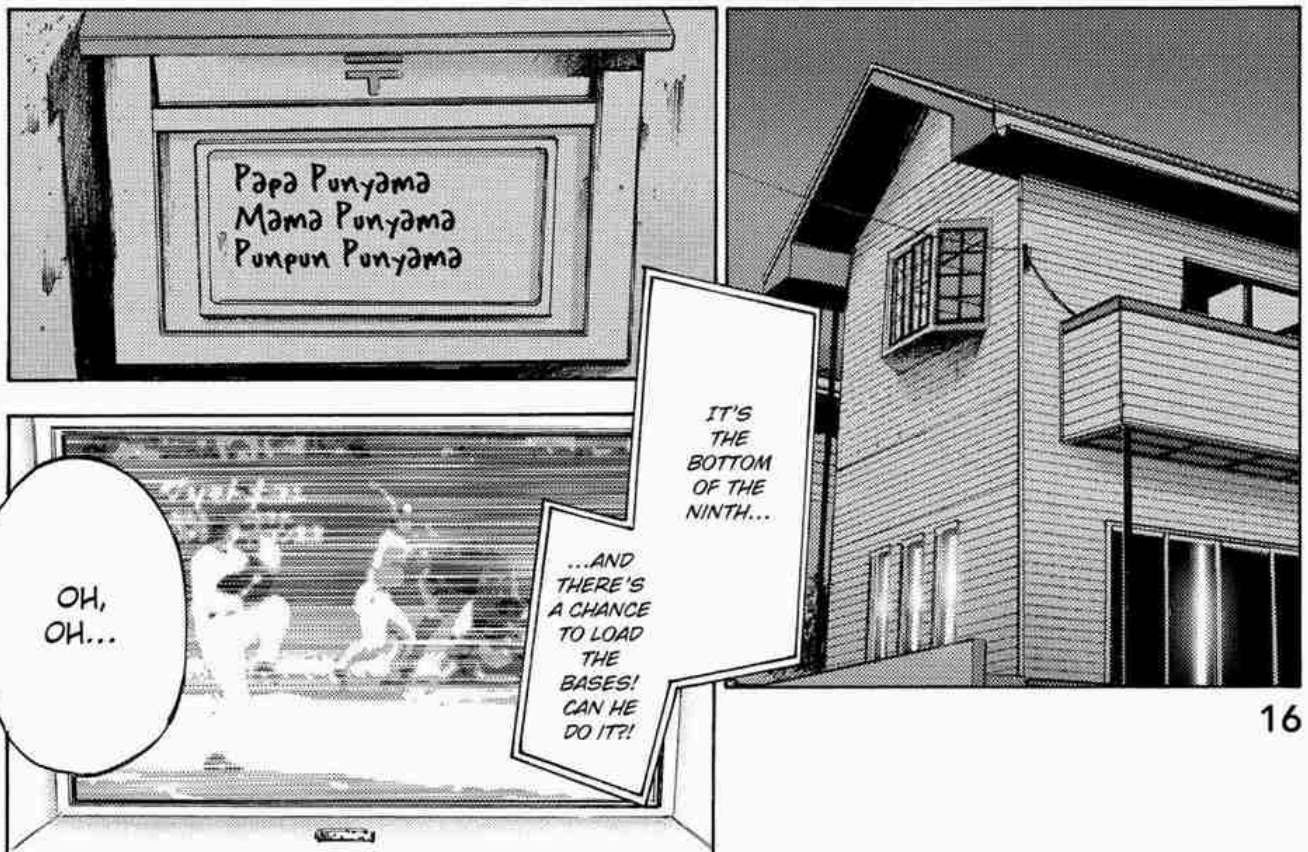

SEI
SEI
SEI
SEI
募集
NEW MEMBERS WANTED
COSMO HEALTH CENTER


SEE YOU TOMOR-ROW!



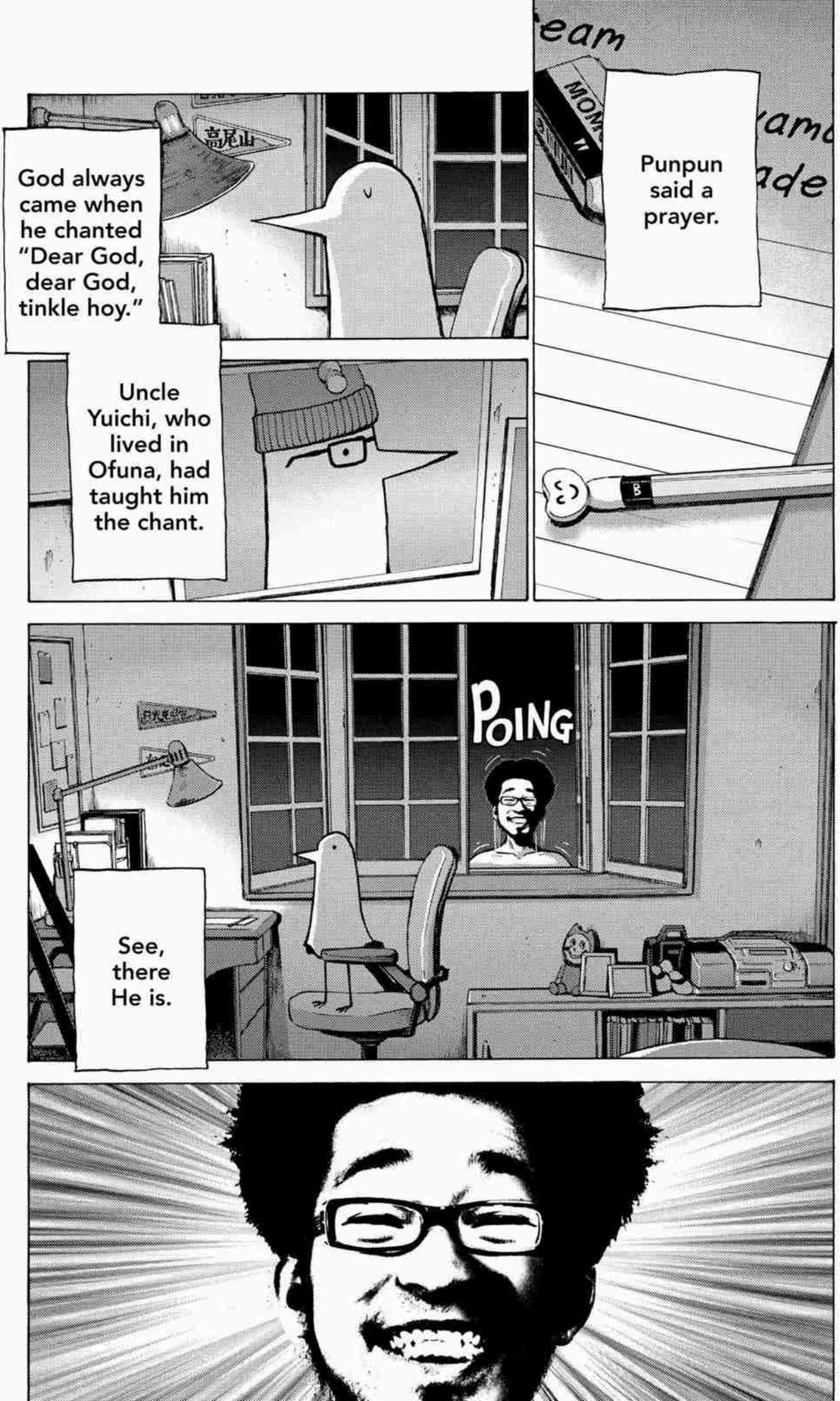
But he fought back the tears.

And as he pondered the kind of adult he would grow up to be, Punpun forgot the way home and almost started to cry.




IT'S A HIT!
YES!
RUN! RUN!
Punpun's dream was to play pro baseball.
NOW THAT'S WHAT I CALL A VICTORY FOR THE GIANTS!
He had never actually played baseball before, but it made Punpun feel good to see his father enjoying the live broadcasts.
But sometimes Punpun found himself questioning whether that really meant he wanted to play baseball.
MAMA, GET ME A BEER!
OH, WE'RE OUT.
A GAME LIKE THAT...
...MAKES ME WANT TO HIT A HOME RUN IN BED TONIGHT!
OUT...
HOW CAN WE BE OUT, YOU IDIOT?!


I KNOW WE HAVE BEER IN THE FRIDGE!
SO GET ME A BEER, BITCH!
CRASH
THAT BEER WAS PAID FOR WITH MONEY I EARNED!
AHHH!
BUT, DEAR, YOU'VE BEEN UN-EMPLOYED FOR A YEAR!
YOU'VE ALREADY HAD YOUR BEER QUOTA FOR THE NIGHT!
THAT ...
THAT'S ...
... BECAUSE ...
...I COULDN'T ...
...TRANSFER AND LEAVE YOU GUYS!
WHAM
I DIDN'T THINK THEY'D FIRE ME FOR SAYING NO!
YOU'RE MY WIFE! YOU SHOULD BE MORE SYMPATHETIC!
I DID IT FOR YOU!!
Punpun was used to days like these.

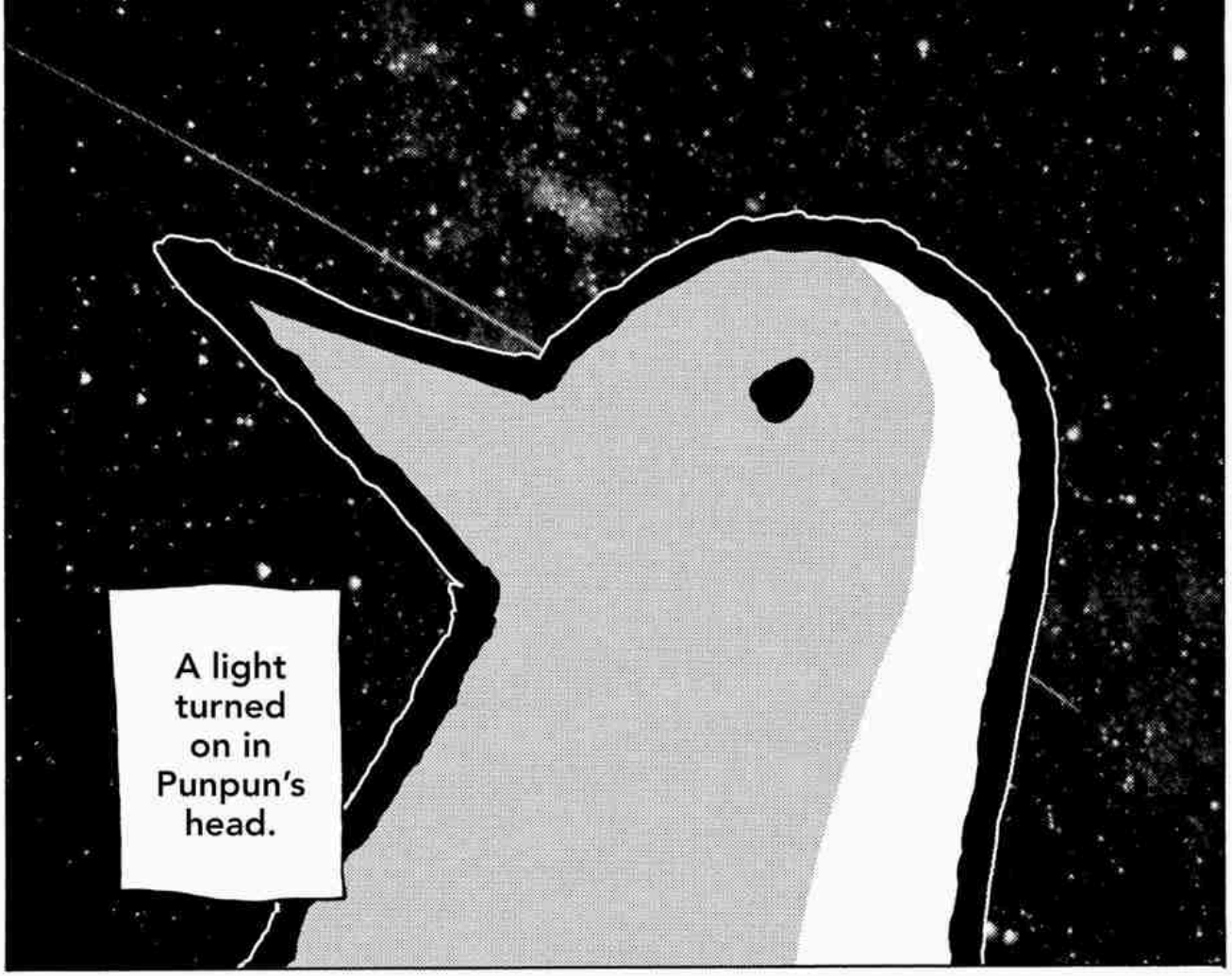

God always came when he chanted "Dear God, dear God, tinkle hoy."
Uncle Yuichi, who lived in Ofuna, had taught him the chant.
Punpun said a prayer.
POING
See, there He is.


What do you want from God, Punpun?
Punpun asked God...
"Can't Mom and Dad get along?"
Frankly, I'm tired of that subject. Is there anything else?


Don't rush it. Think things over carefully, because the possibilities are endless...
Hmmm.
"I...
"I wonder what I'll be like when I'm an adult," thought Punpun.
Just don't grow up to say stuff like that with a straight face...
... PUNPUN!


OH, I'M SORRY. ARE YOU STUDYING?
RUSTLE RUSTLE RUSTLE
LOOK, I HAVE A PRESENT FOR YOU, PUNPUN.
IT'S A TELE-SCOPE!
ISN'T IT GREAT ?!
I WON IT PLAYING THE SLO-
I MEAN, A FRIEND GAVE IT TO ME.
NO MATTER HOW FAR AWAY IT IS, EVERY-THING...
...LOOKS WITHIN REACH THROUGH THIS, YOU KNOW?


THIS IS AROUND THE TIME... YES! LOOK, SEE THAT TRIANGLE IN THE EASTERN SKY?
THE STAR AT THE VERY TOP IS VEGA, IN THE LYRA CONSTELLA-TION.
VEGA IS 27 LIGHT-YEARS AWAY FROM EARTH.
IN OTHER WORDS, YOU'RE SEEING LIGHT FROM 27 YEARS AGO.
HMM? CAN YOU SEE NERIMA WITH THIS?
NAH, IT'S PROBABLY TOO CLOSE.
ANYWAY, A MAN'S GOT TO DREAM BIG!
I'LL NEVER GO TO OUTER SPACE.
BUT DREAMING ABOUT IT IS GREAT!



"That's it. I'll study outer space."

"I'll study hard, really hard, and become a space expert.

Punpun Puny
Fifth G

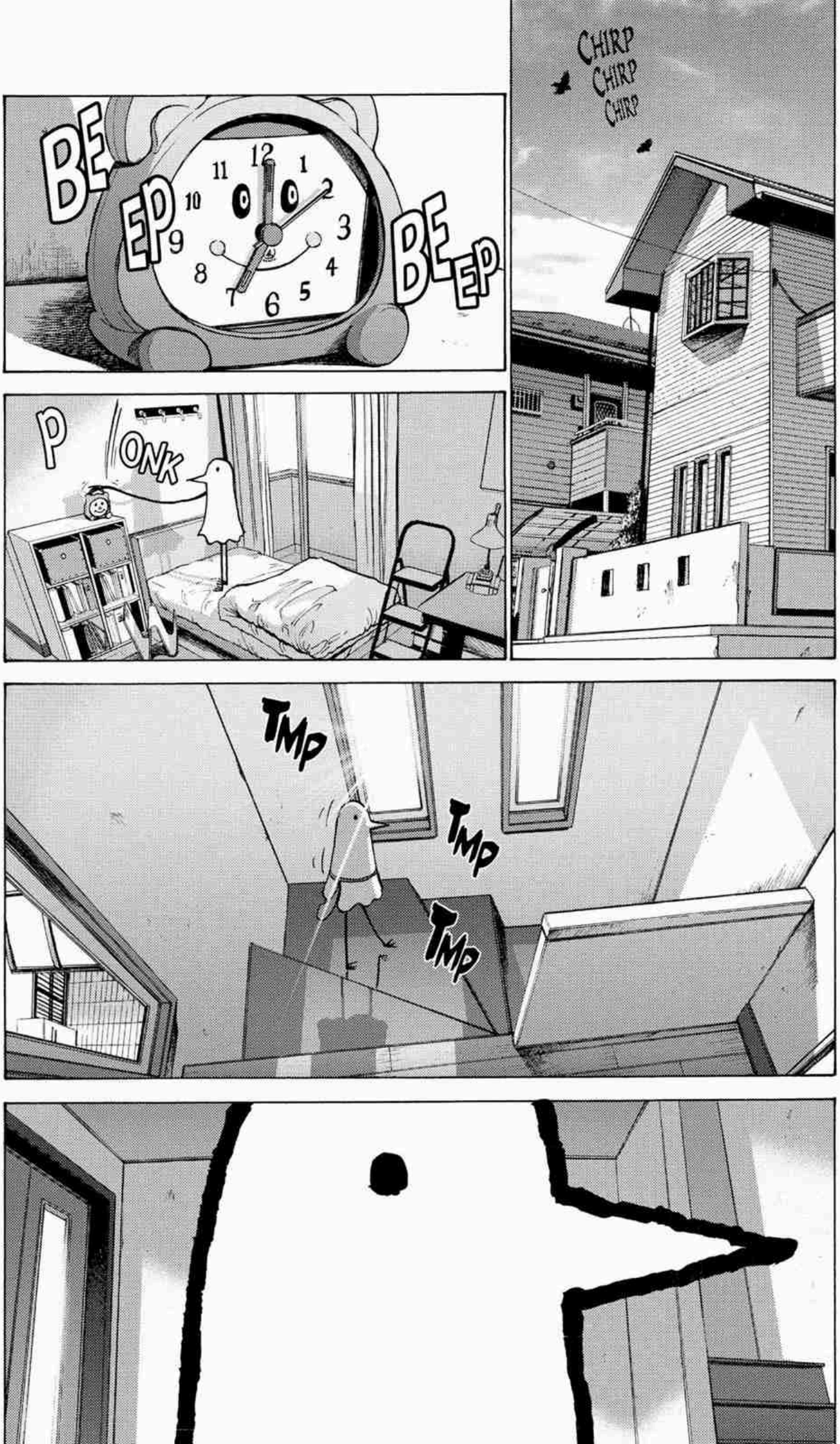
My dream is to research outer s
'll study all about outer space an
come a professor. When I beco
ofessor, I think I want to study about
ace migration. In order to do that,
have to study lots and lots and go
lots of universities. The universe
vast, so even if Japan runs out of
space, we don't have to worry.

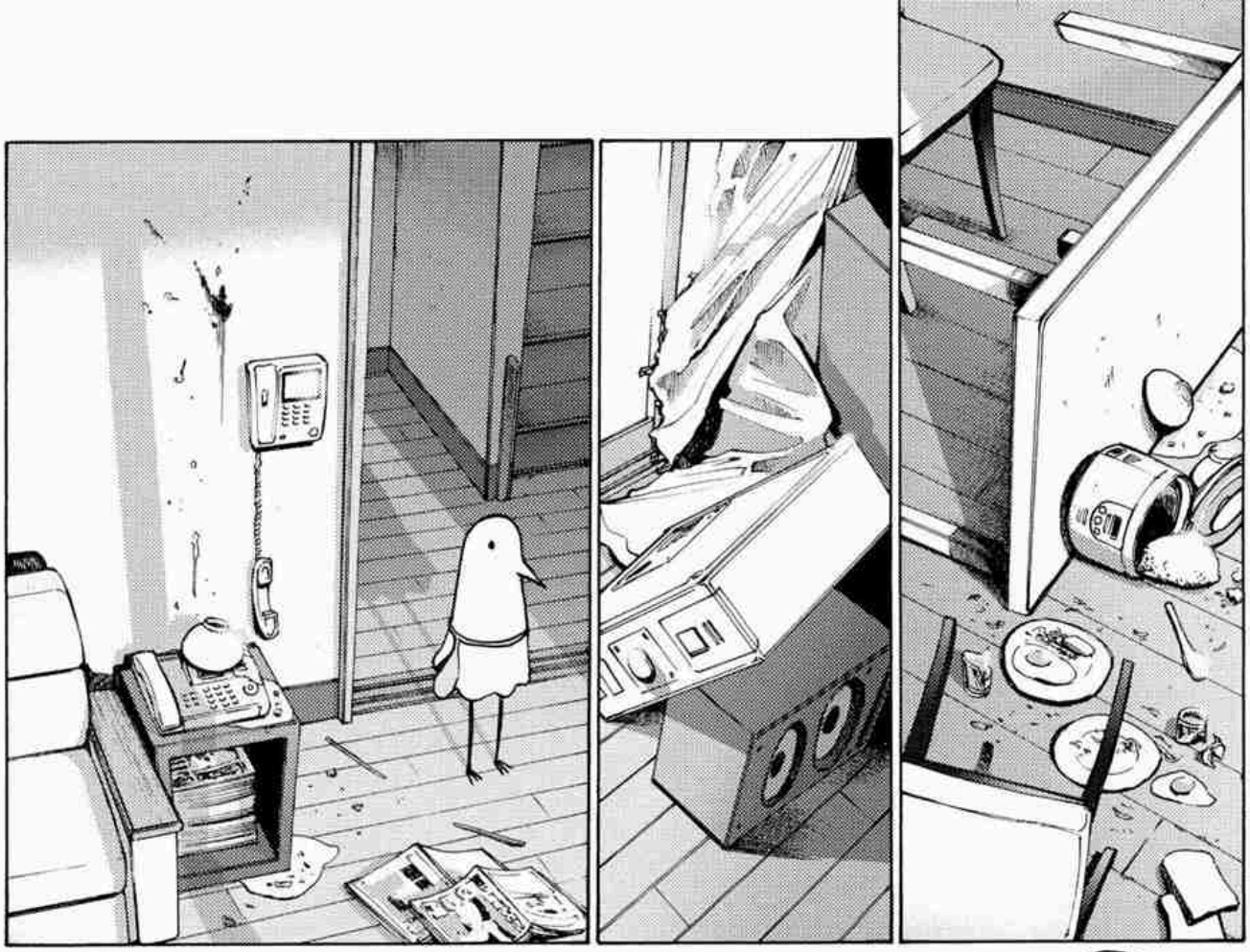
"I'll find a way for mankind to migrate to outer space!

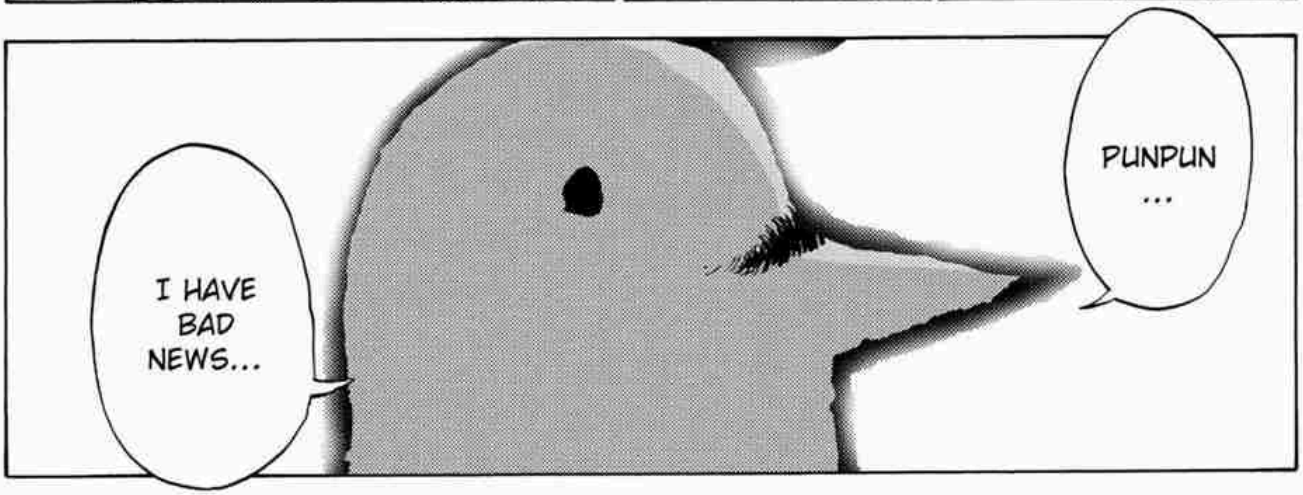




"...Aiko will like me!"

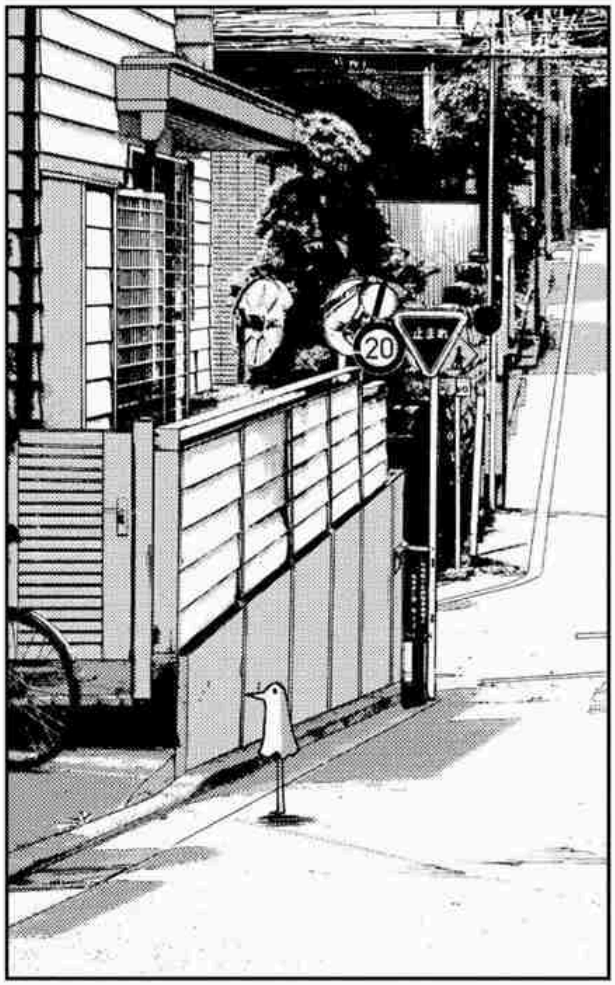

BE
EP
BE
EP
CHIRP
CHIRP
CHIRP
P
ONK
TMP
TMP
TMP




PUNPUN
...
I HAVE BAD NEWS...


THERE WAS A BURGLAR.

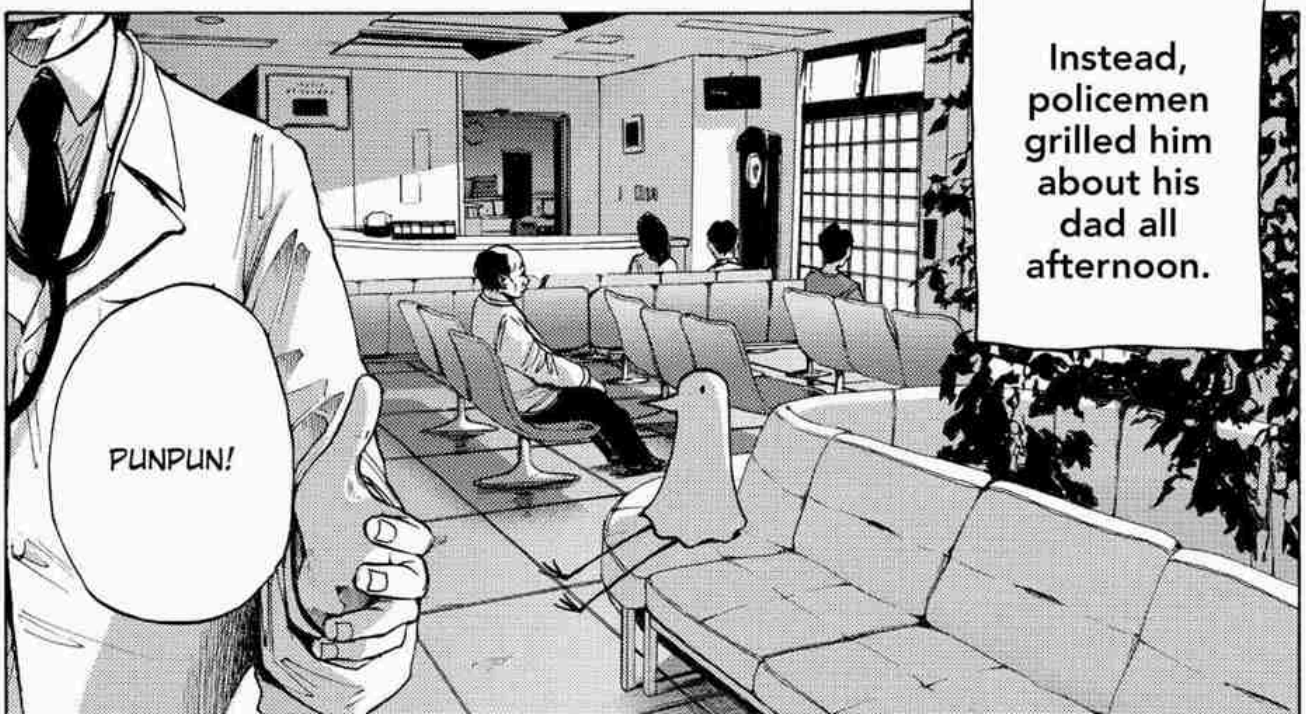

PUNPUN
...
IT'S
TRUE.
SOMEONE
REALLY
BROKE INTO
OUR HOUSE.
YOU
BELIEVE ME,
DON'T YOU,
PUNPUN?!


20
止まれ

Chapter 2

Punpun didn't go to school that day.

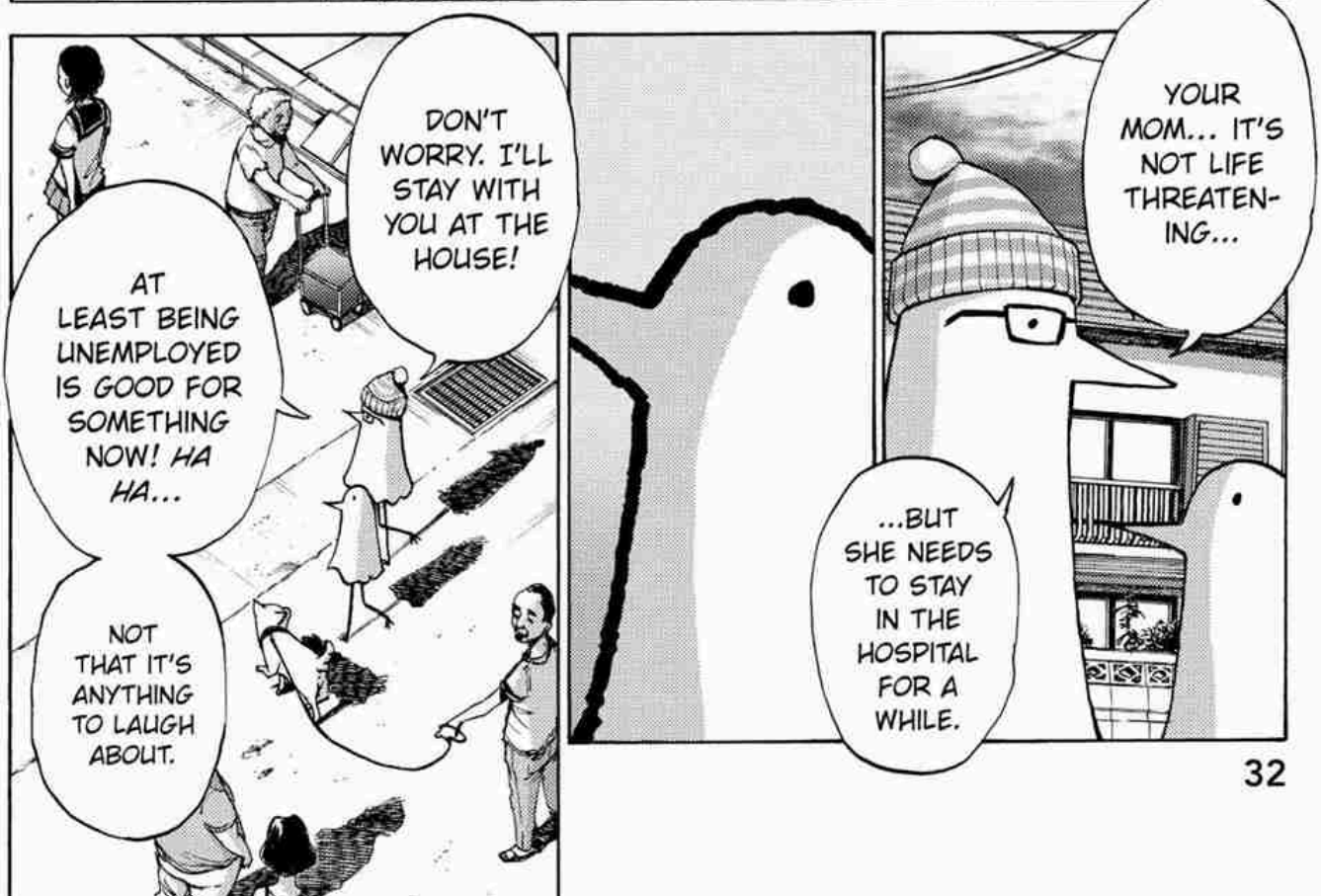






Uncle Yuichi was there to pick up Punpun.

Uncle Yuichi was his mother's younger brother and lived in Ofuna with Granny.




WHOA, HE REALLY DID A NUMBER ON THIS PLACE.
I MEAN, I KNOW HE GOES ALL OUT ON THINGS, BUT, WHOA...
HMM?
LET'S HAVE A LITTLE FUN BEFORE WE CLEAN UP!
ROBOT!

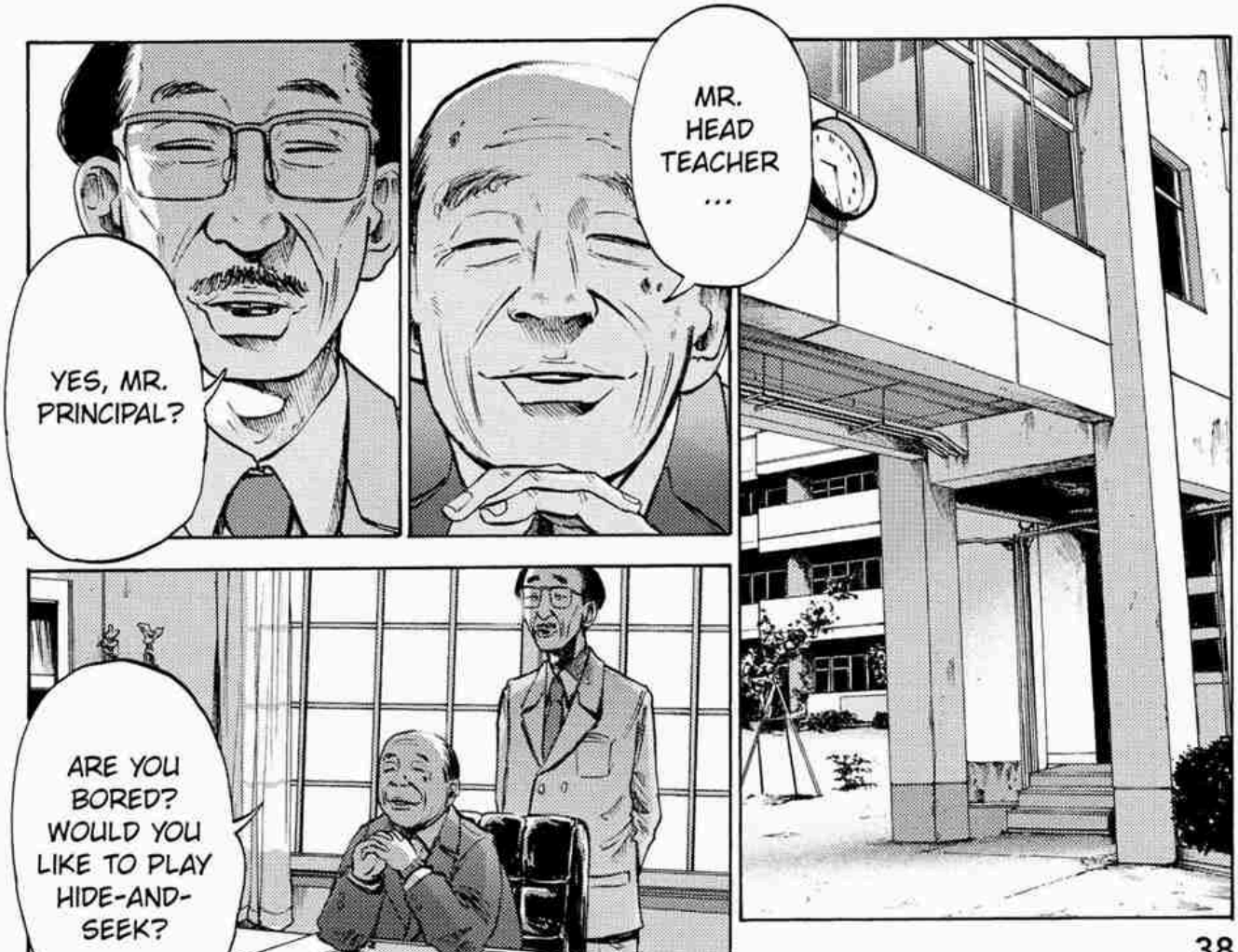

The next day, Punpun went to school as usual.
OH...
As he expected, Aiko was already popular with the other students.
MORNING ...
H-HI, PUNPUN!


OKAY, GOOD MORNING, EVERYONE!
WE'RE DOING LANGUAGE ARTS FOR THE FIRST HOUR!
BUT BEFORE THAT...!
NYA NYA!
WAH HA HA!
PUNPUN!
DID YOU FINISH THE ESSAY I ASSIGNED TWO DAYS AGO?
WHAT'S THE MATTER?
DON'T TELL ME YOU DIDN'T DO IT?
Being called on with no warning made Punpun a little nervous.
EVERYONE READ THEIR ESSAYS TO THE CLASS YESTERDAY MORNING.
SO NOW LET'S HEAR YOURS.


AHHHH!
RAHHH!
YOU HAVE TO DO YOUR HOME-WORK!
WONK
WO
NK
AHHH!
YOU HAVE TO DO IT, NO MATTER WHAT!!
WONK
YOU SHOULD KNOOOW THAT!


WE ALL HAVE BURDENS TO SHOULDER.
I KNOW THAT.
BUT IT'S UNFAIR TO MAKE AN EXCEPTION. RIGHT?
WE HAVE TO BE FAIR...
WHAT THE HELL IS FAIR, ANY-WAY?!
GYA AAA AAA AAH!
DON'T GET COCKY JUST BECAUSE YOU'RE KIDS!
NOO OOO OO!
SIR...
I THINK PUNPUN DID HIS HOME-WORK...
Punpun Punpuns
Fifth Grade
My dream is to research outer space. I'll study all about outer space and become a professor.
When I become a professor, I think I want


PSYCH!


MR. HEAD TEACHER ...
YES, MR. PRINCIPAL?
ARE YOU BORED? WOULD YOU LIKE TO PLAY HIDE-AND-SEEK?


EEEEE!
YES, I WOULD.
OKAY, THEN. ROCK, PAPER...
... SCISSORS.
EEE!



Punpun's dream was to become a space expert and help people emigrate to another planet.

Punpun had every confidence in his plans.

OKAY ...

WHAT'S YOUR DREAM, PUNPUN?

But...

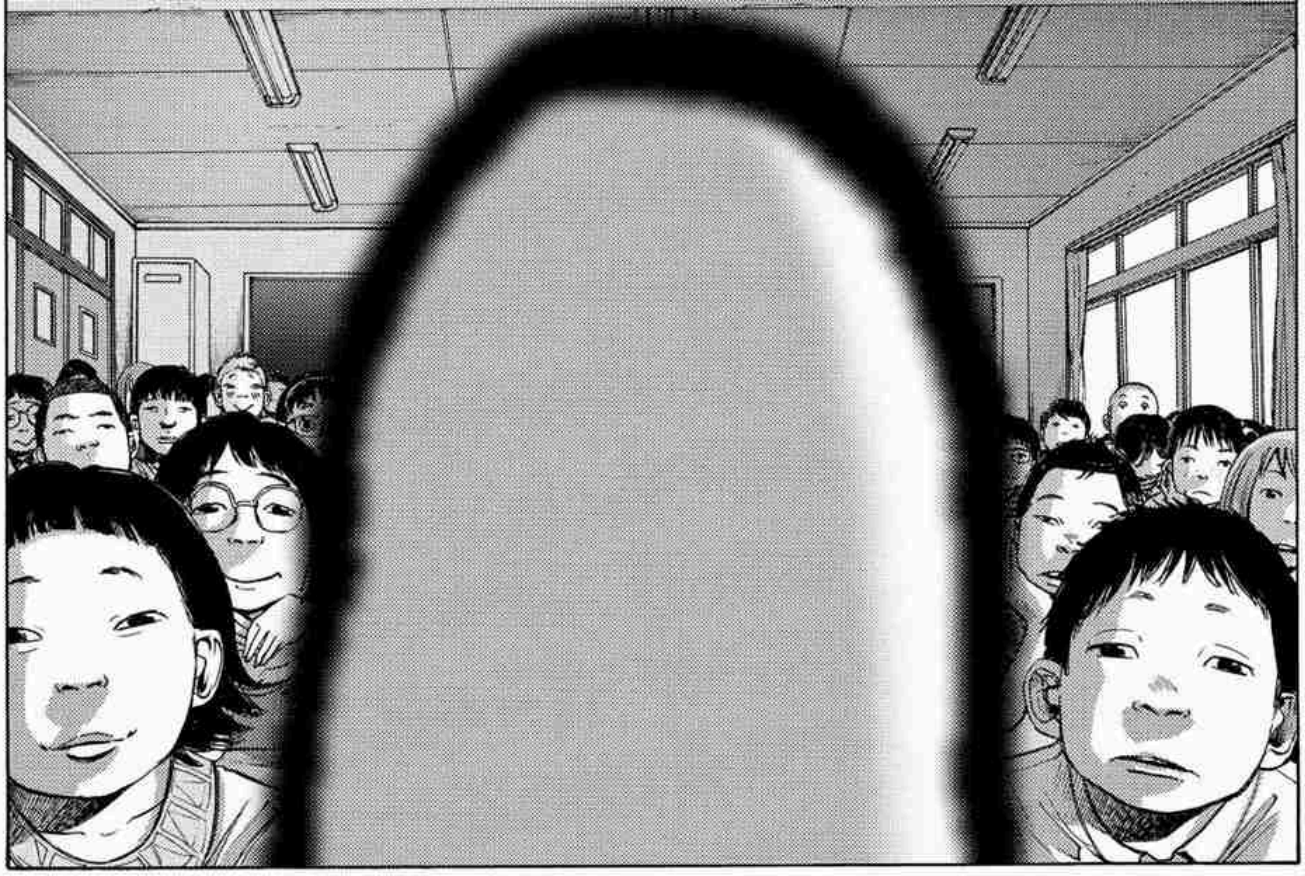
Fifth Grade

s to research outer space.
about outer space and
rofessor. When I become a
. I think I want to study abo
gration. In order to do that.
study lots and lots and go
universities. The universe
so even if Japan runs out of
e, we don't have to worry.

able to migrate to outer

But what if...

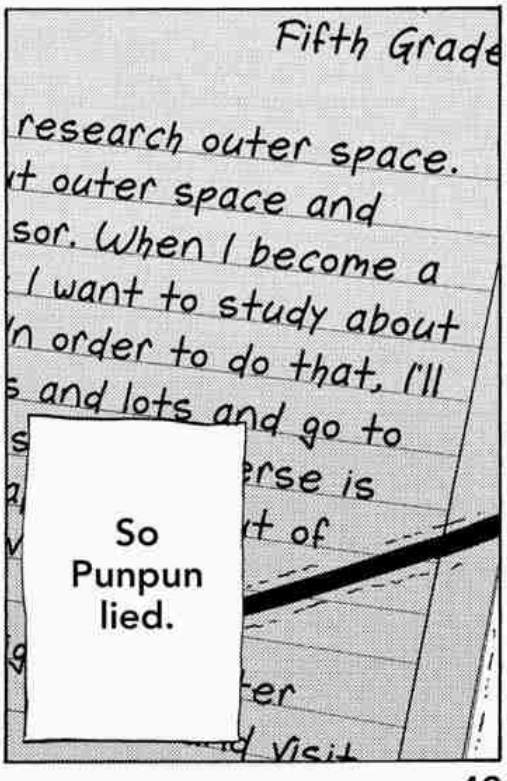

And...
...someone in class pointed out that it was impossible and made fun of him...?
...Aiko was watching!
That thought ...
...made Punpun so embarrassed, he felt like he was going to die.
CLAP CLAP
SPEAK UP SO WE CAN ALL HEAR!
OKAY, PUNPUN!

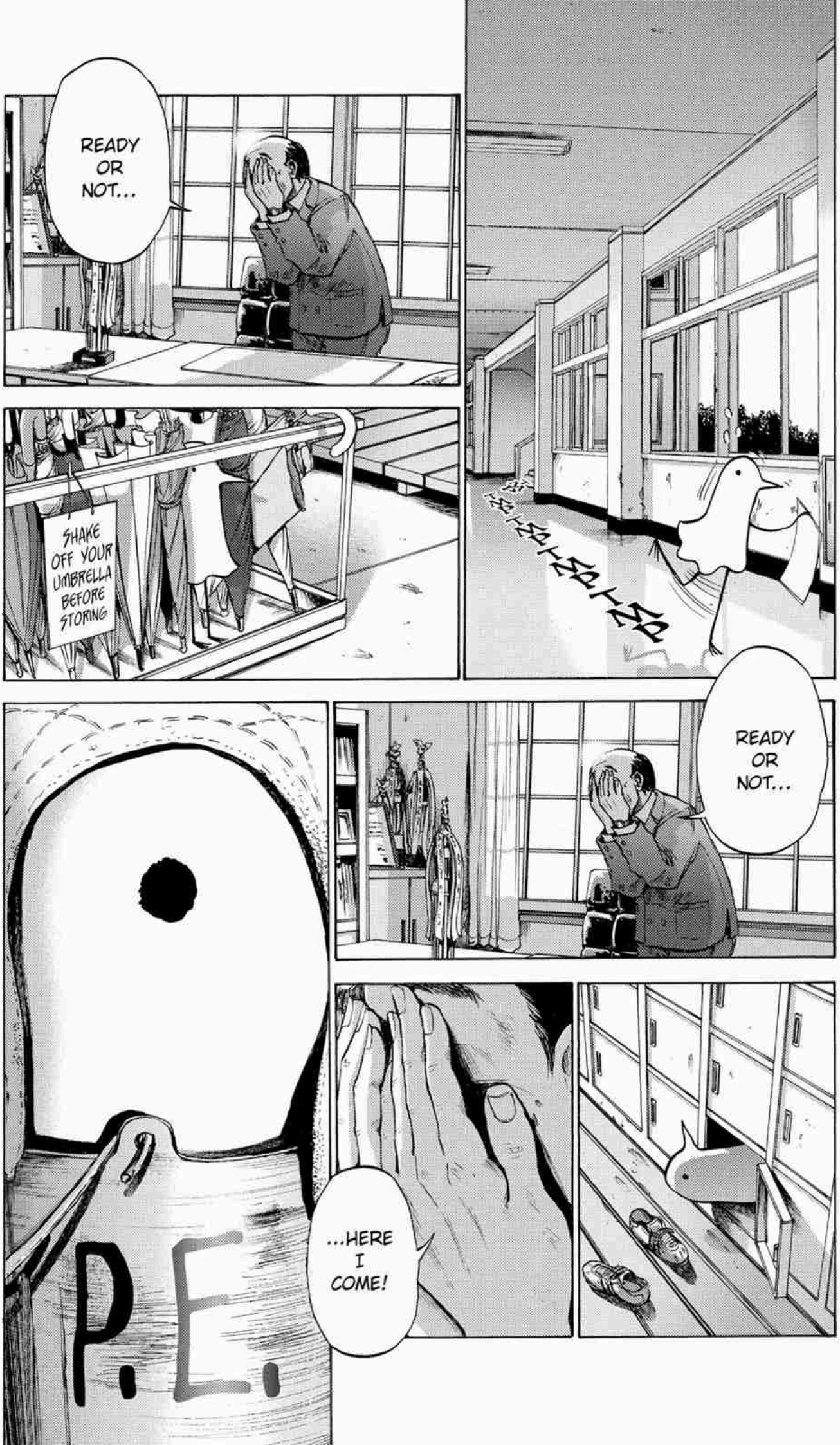


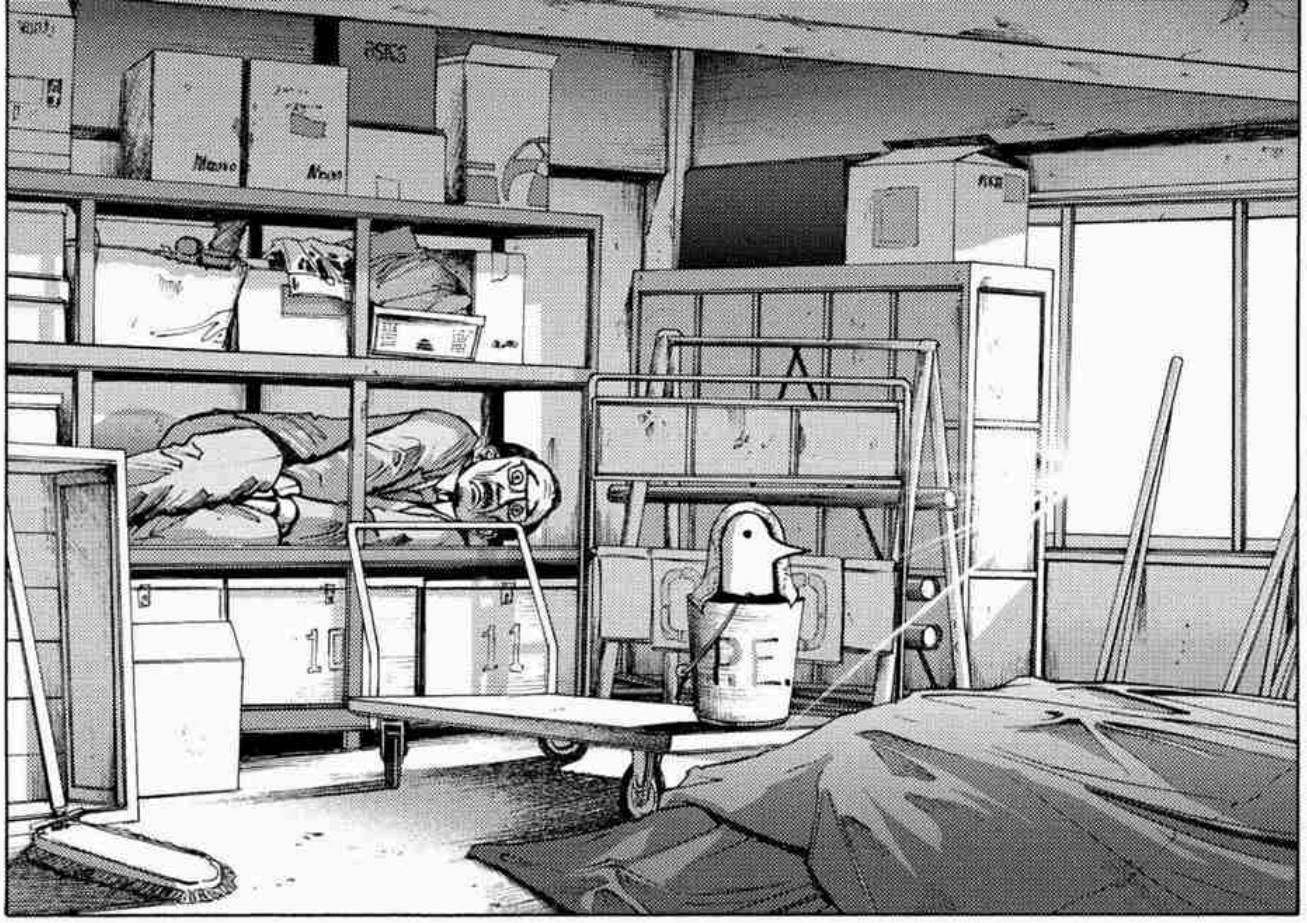
"My dream is to work in an average office and have an average family."

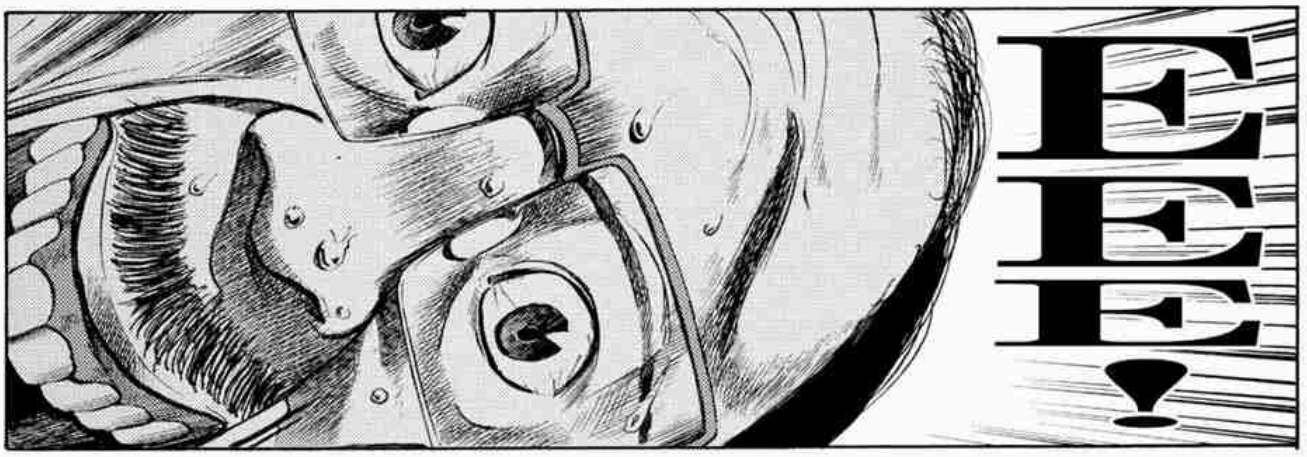







READY OR NOT...
SHAKE OFF YOUR UMBRELLA BEFORE STORING
READY OR NOT...
P.E.!
...HERE I COME!


10
11
RE.

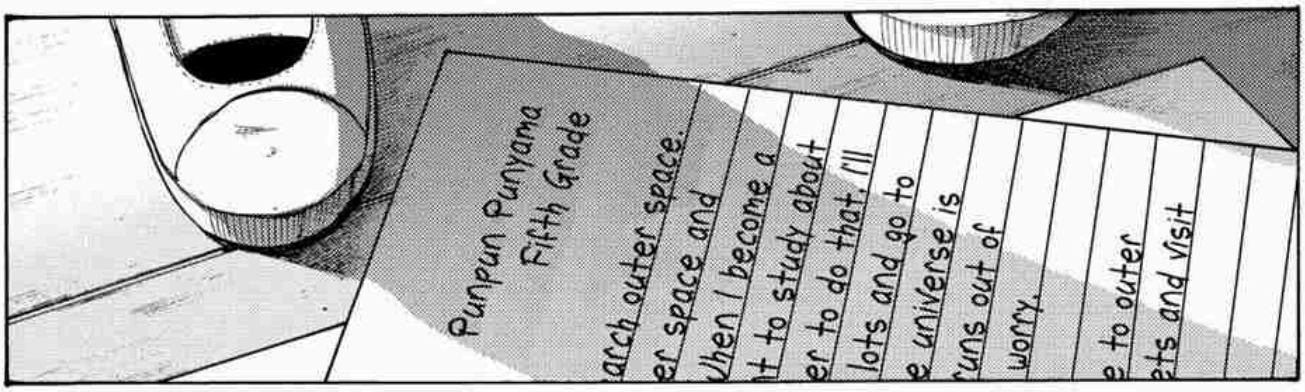

EE!

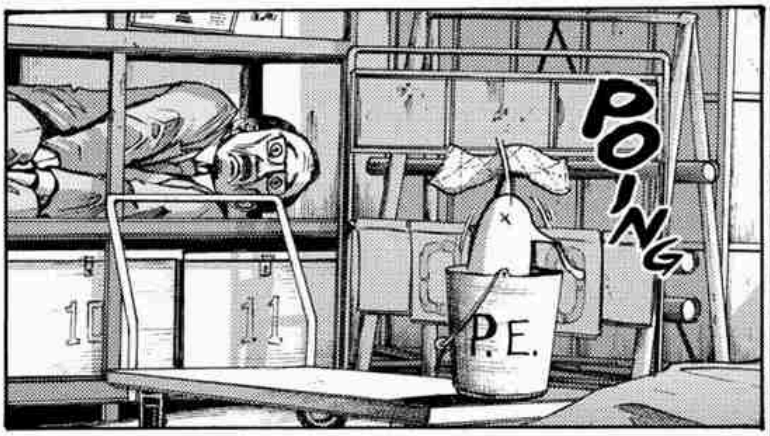

AAH!

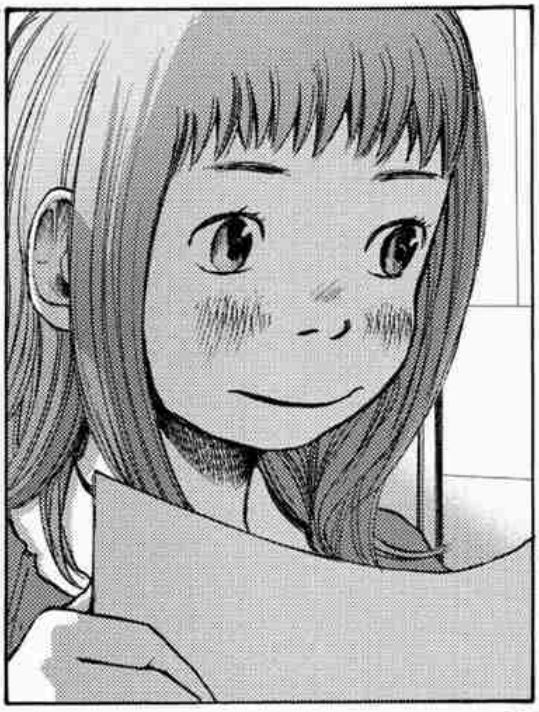

PRINCIPAL


PUNPUN WAS ACTING WEIRD.
HEY!
I HEARD MY MOM TALKING ABOUT WHAT HAPPENED WITH HIS DAD. THAT'S PROBABLY WHY.
IS THERE SOMETHING WE CAN DO TO MAKE HIM FEEL BETTER?
THE POLICE ARE HOLDING PUNPUN'S DAD, RIGHT?
BECAUSE THEY THINK *HE* CAUSED ALL THAT DAMAGE?
I DIDN'T KNOW WHAT TO SAY TO PUNPUN THIS MORNING.
ME NEITHER.
WHY NOT TREAT HIM NORMALLY?
WHAT'S "NORMAL" ANYWAY?

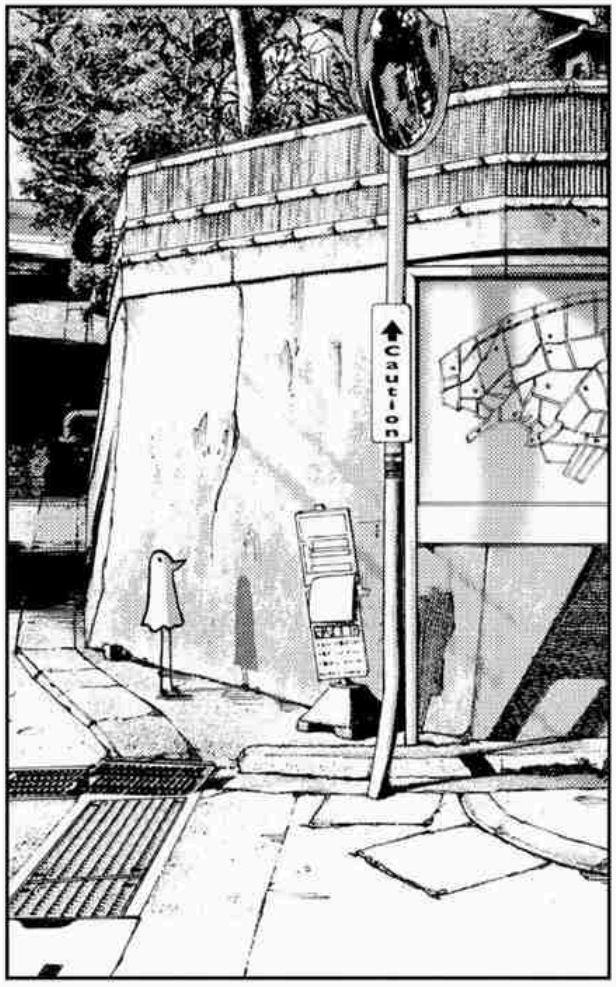

"NORMAL" IS PRETTY HARD...


Punpun Punyama
Fifth Grade
arch outer space.
er space and
hen I become a
t to study about
er to do that, I'll
lots and go to
e universe is
runs out of
worry.
e to outer
ets and visit


POING
P.E.

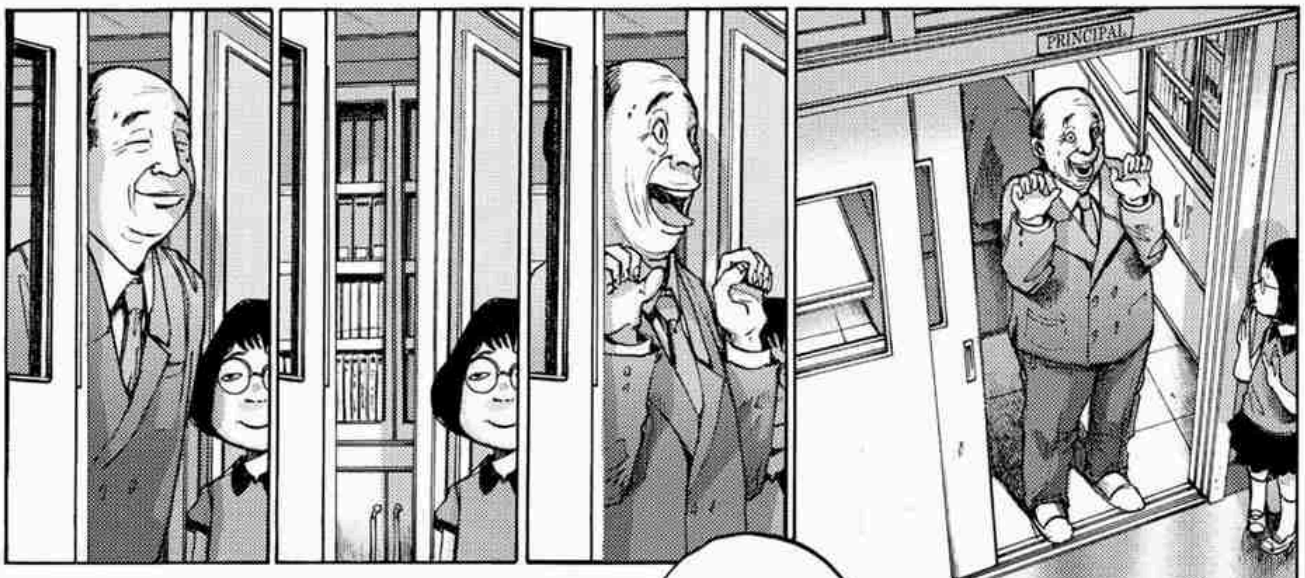


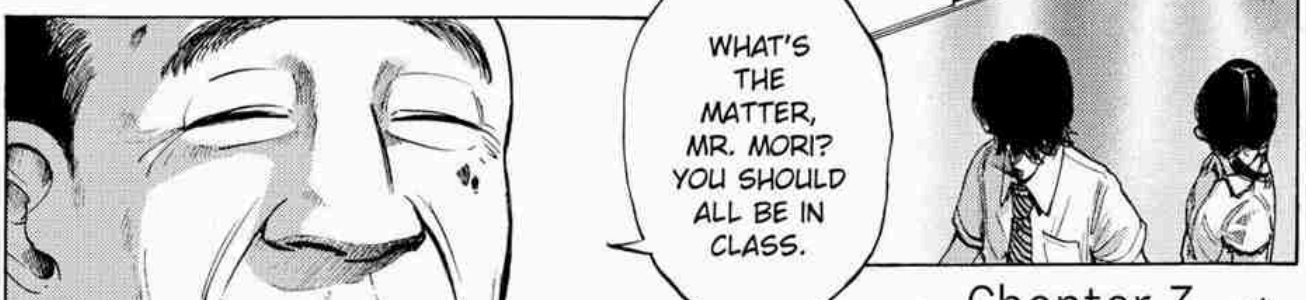

EEE!


Caution

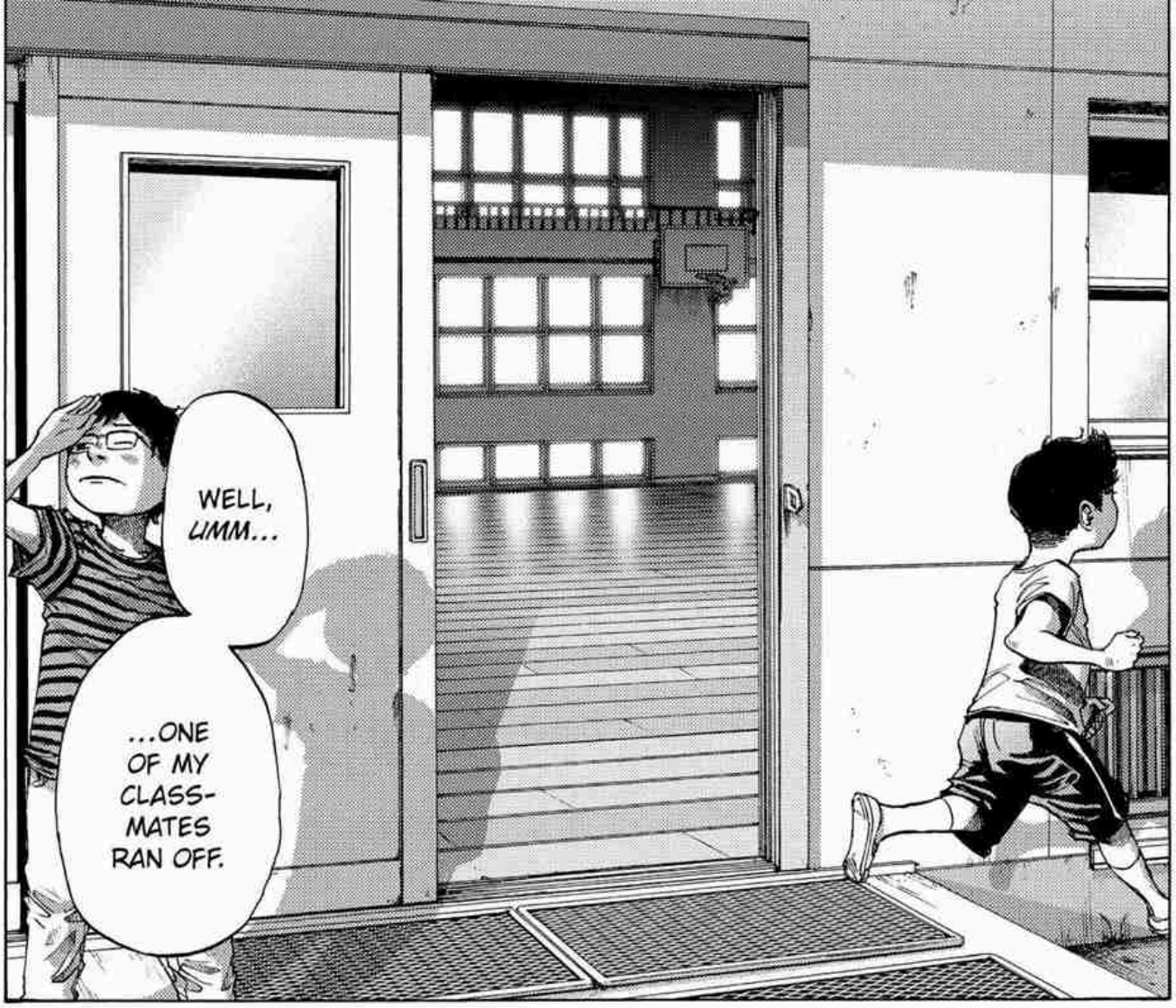

AAH
YA-A

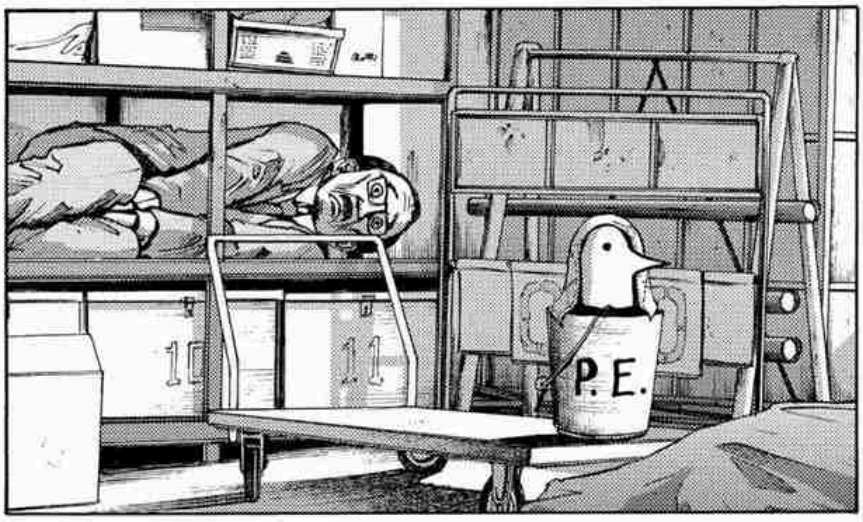



PRINCIPAL


WHAT'S THE MATTER, MR. MORI? YOU SHOULD ALL BE IN CLASS.

Chapter 3



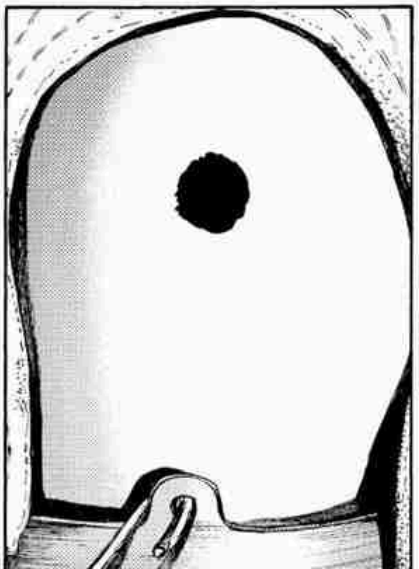


Punpun was deep in thought.

He wondered if helping mankind emigrate to another planet was an impossible dream for him.

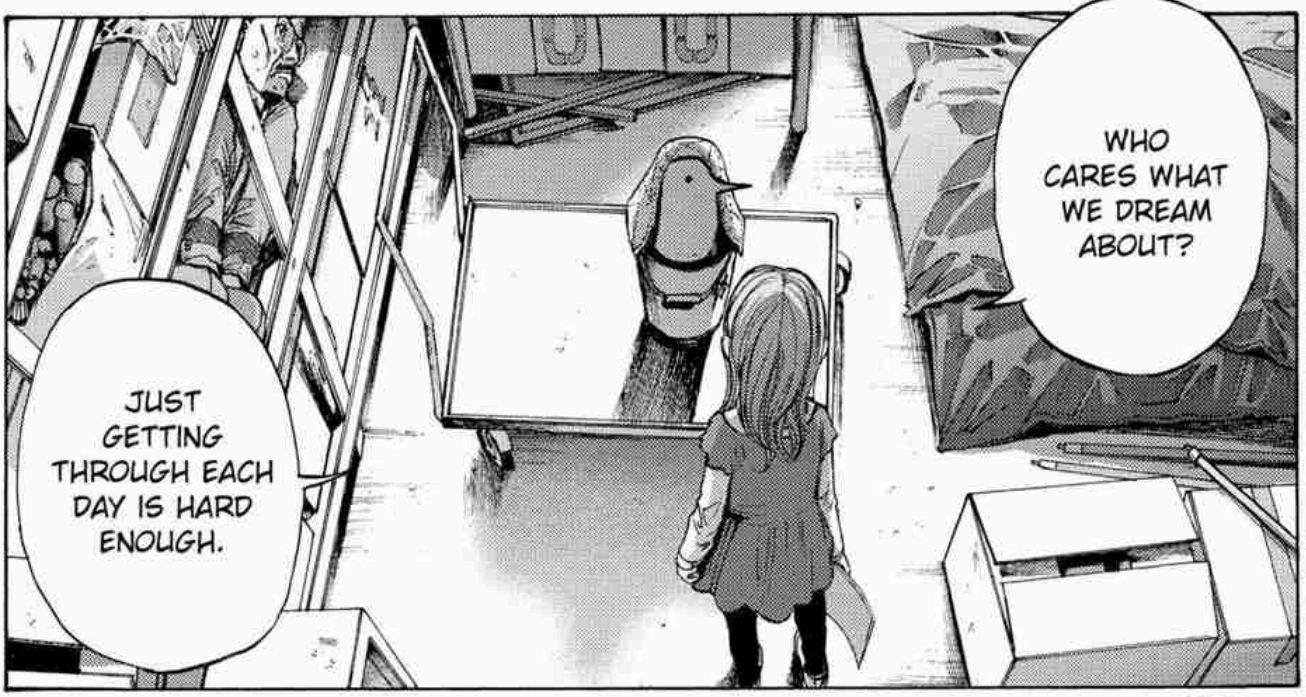
He was so confused...

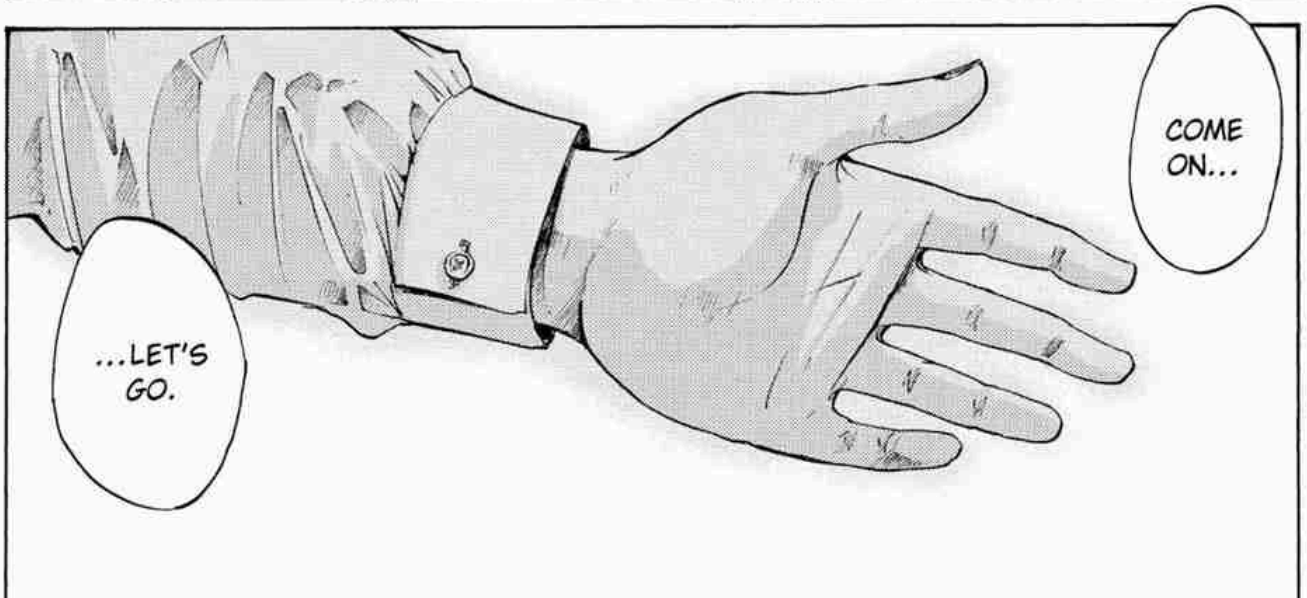
...he wasn't even sure if he wanted to become a space expert anymore.

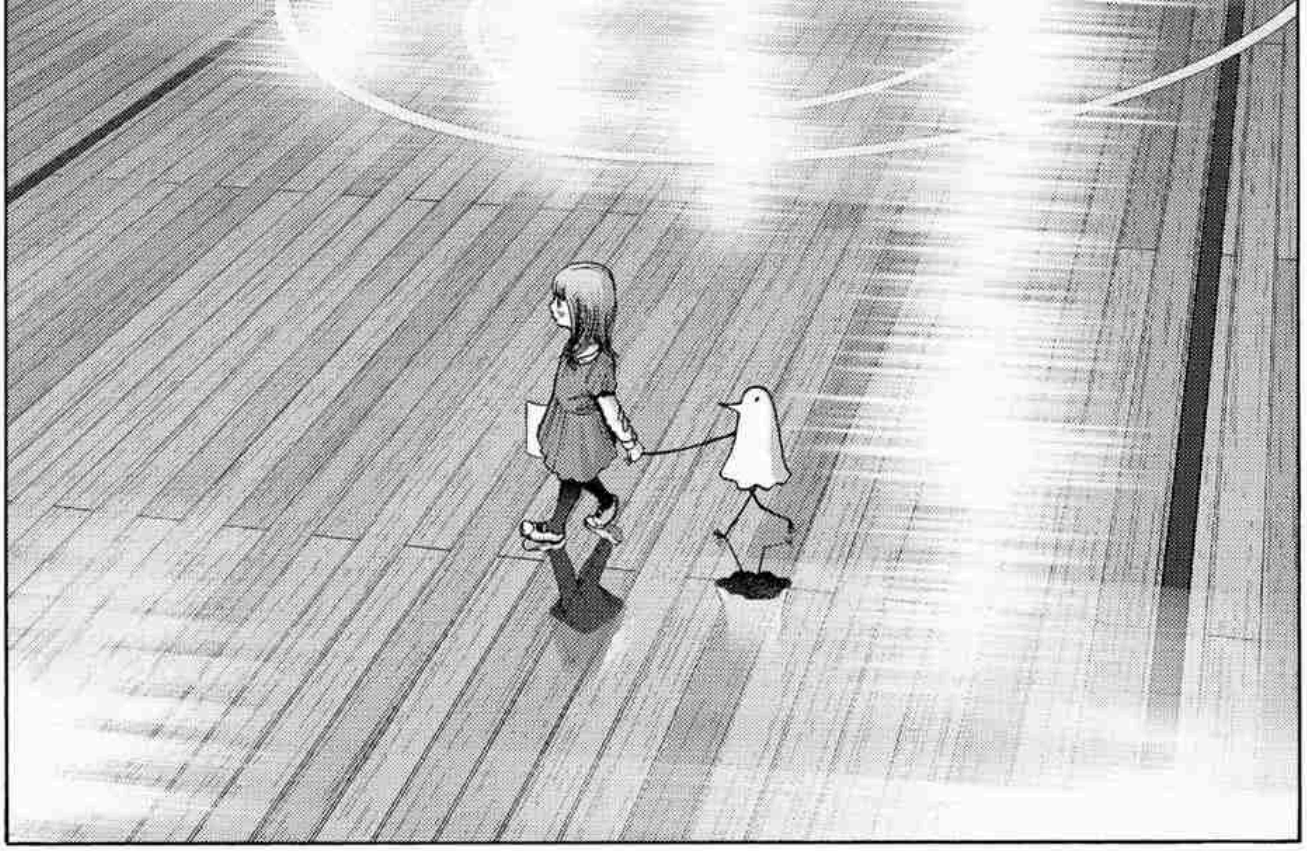



PUNPUN!
EEE!
WHY DID YOU LIE?
BEING A PROFESSOR IS COOL.
YOU SHOULD SPEAK UP AND TELL EVERYONE...
...THAT YOU'RE GOING TO SAVE THEM FROM EXTINCTION.
YOU'RE A COWARD.


YOU WERE SCARED THEY WERE GOING TO LAUGH AT YOU, RIGHT?
SO LET THEM!
PEOPLE WHO DISCOURAGE OTHERS WILL NEVER FIND THEIR OWN HAPPINESS!


WHO CARES WHAT WE DREAM ABOUT?
JUST GETTING THROUGH EACH DAY IS HARD ENOUGH.

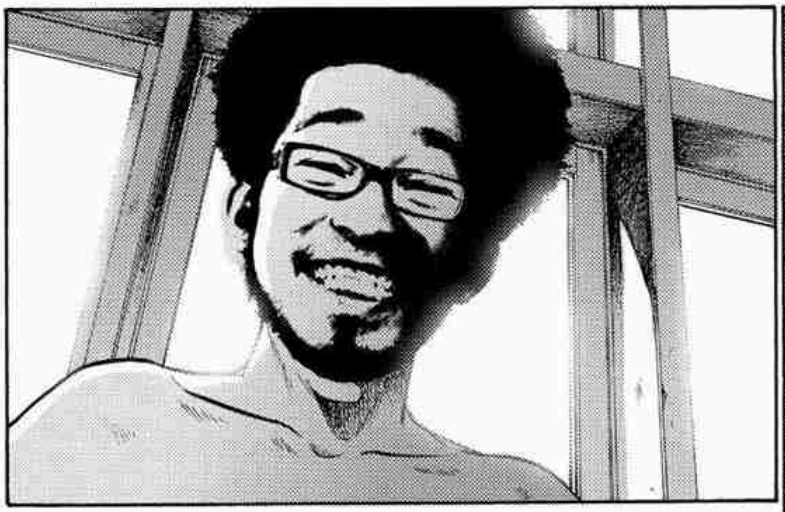

COME ON...
...LET'S GO.

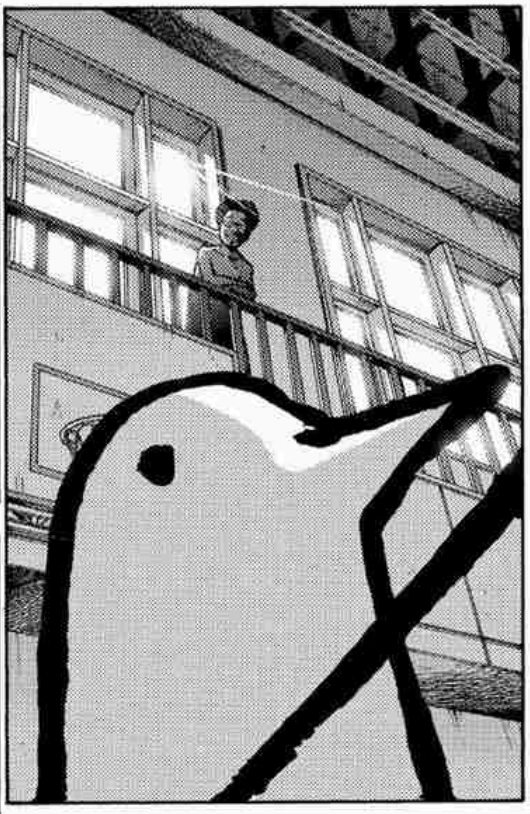


These were the thoughts that crossed Punpun's mind.

...and so small.

Aiko's hand felt soft and warm...



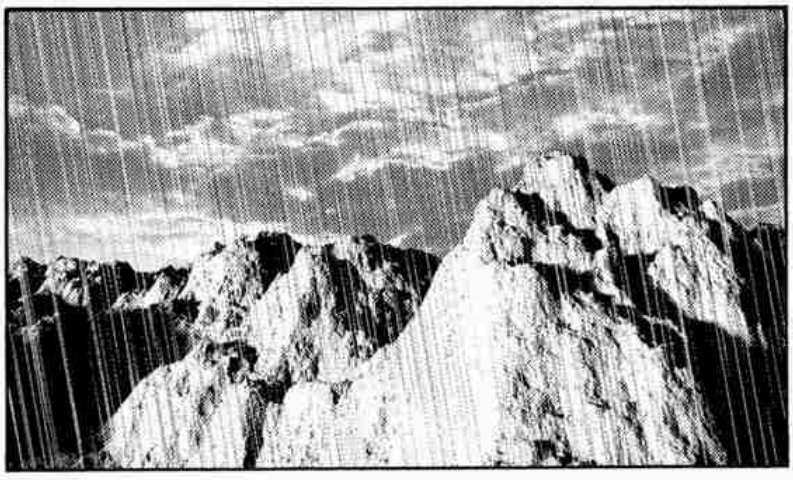


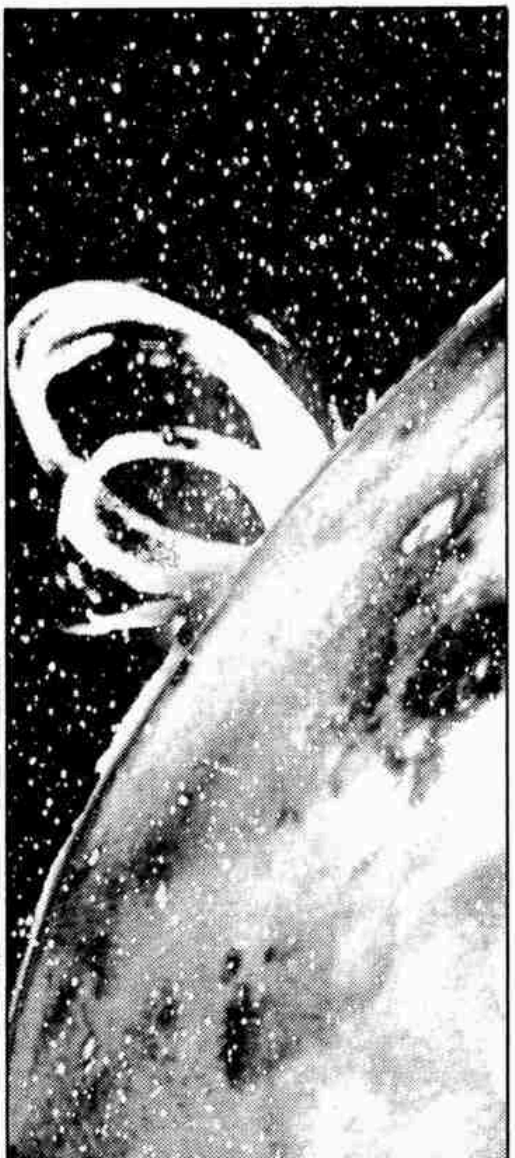
...to let go of her hand.

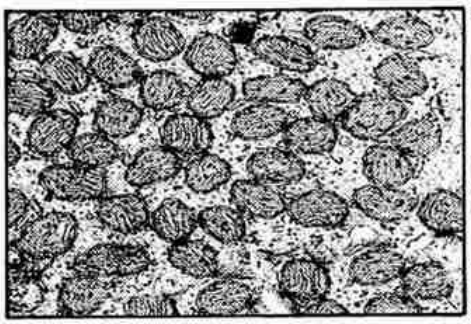
...that he didn't want...

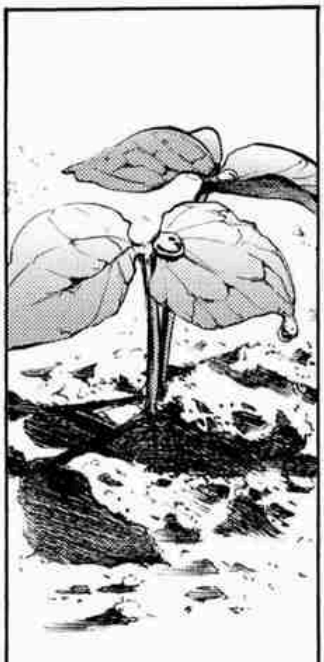
And he also thought...

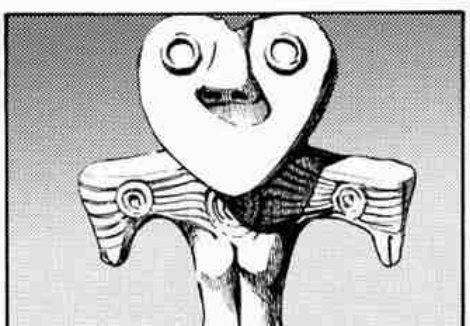


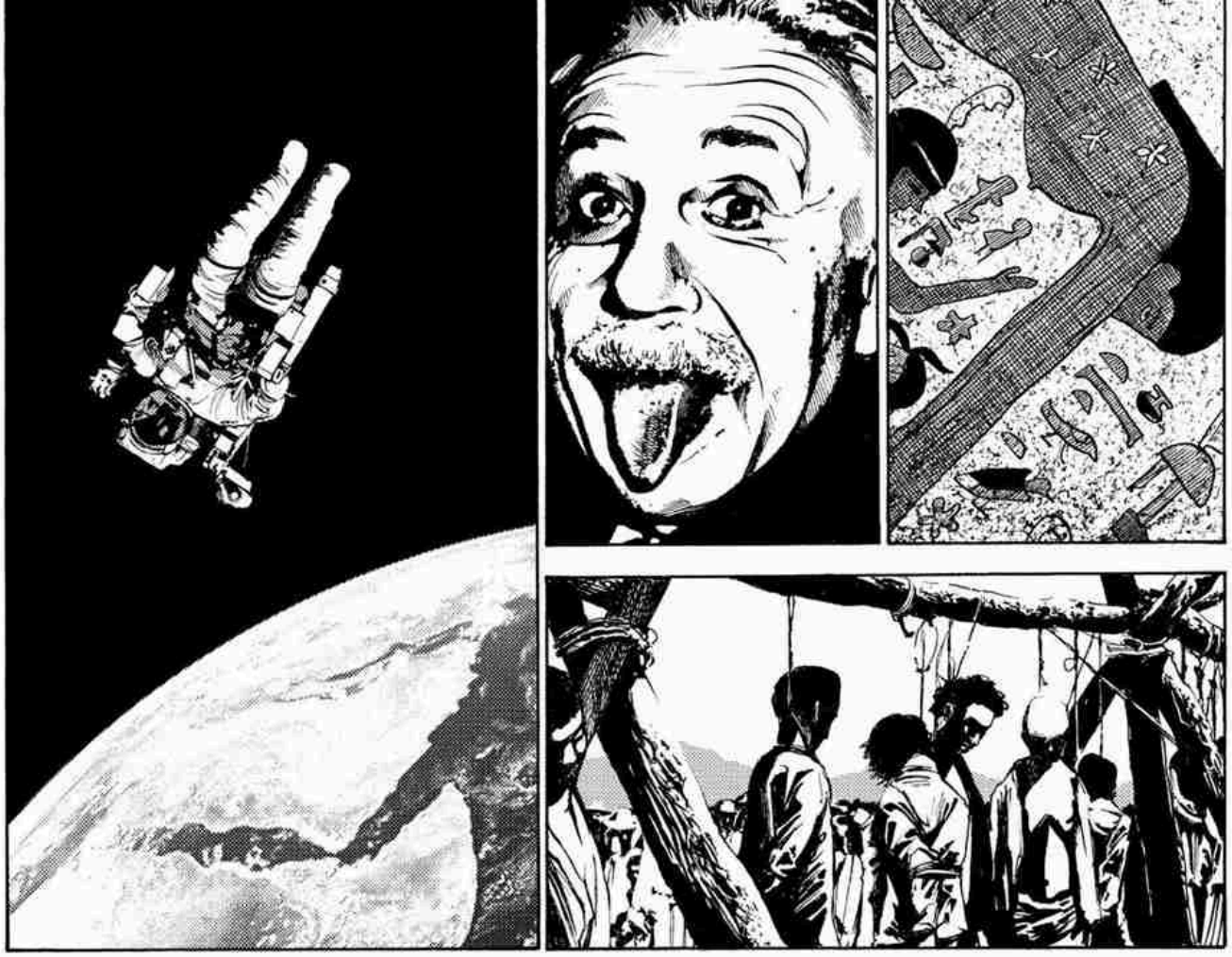


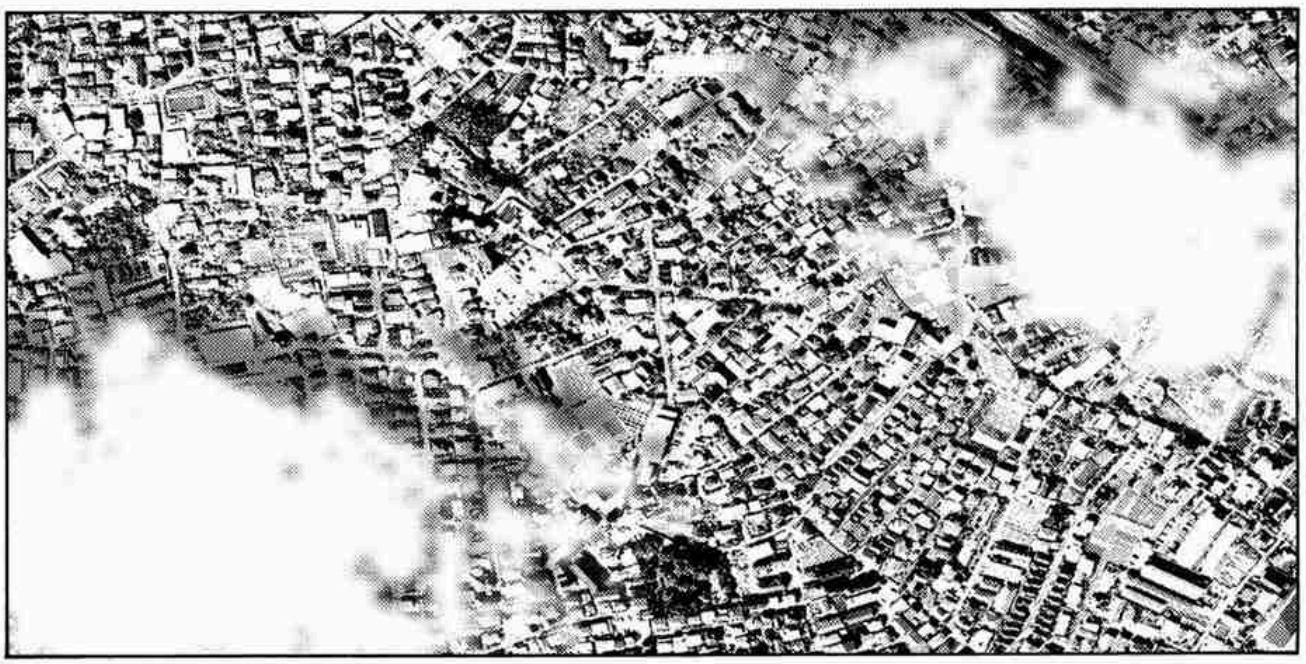








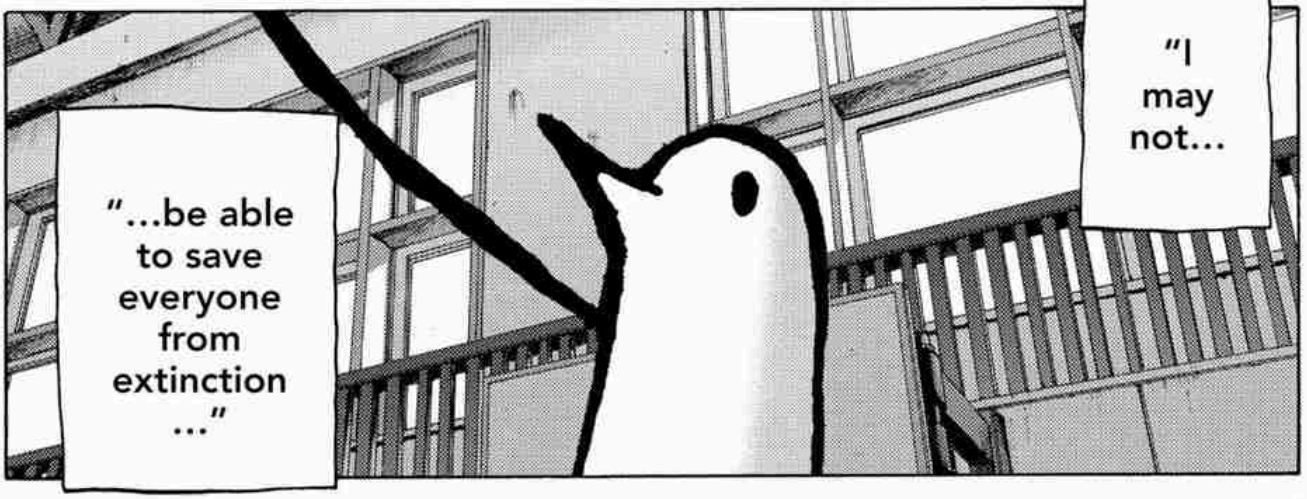


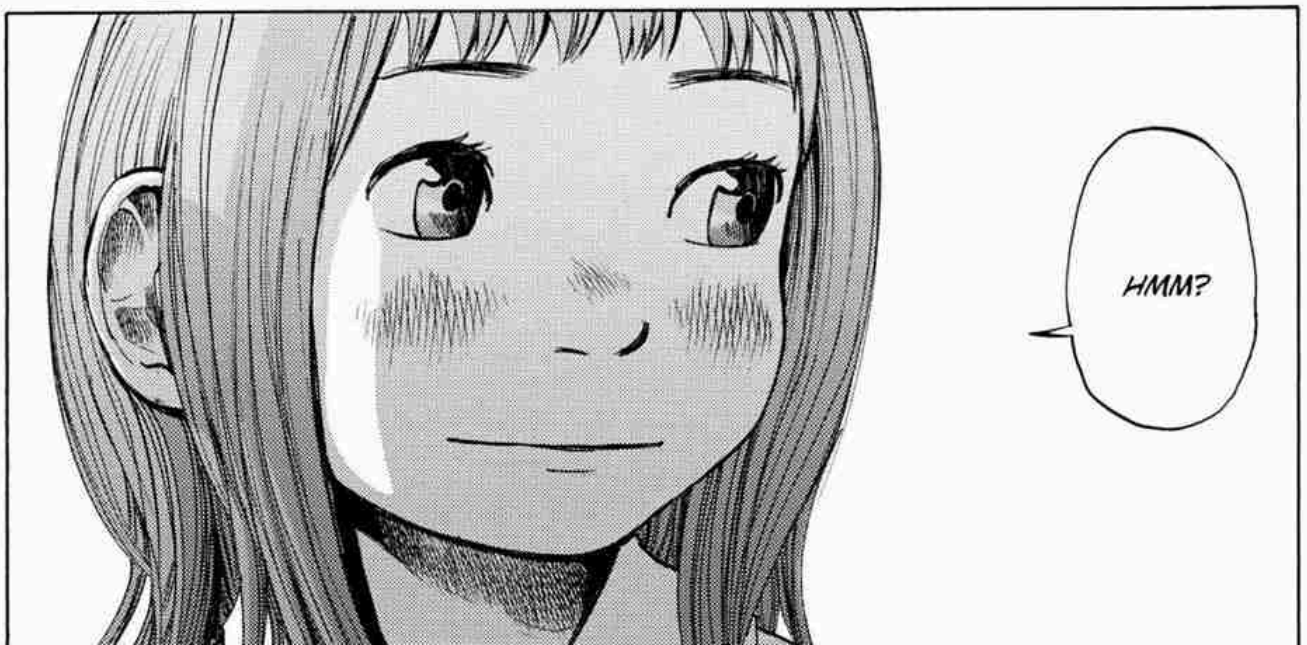


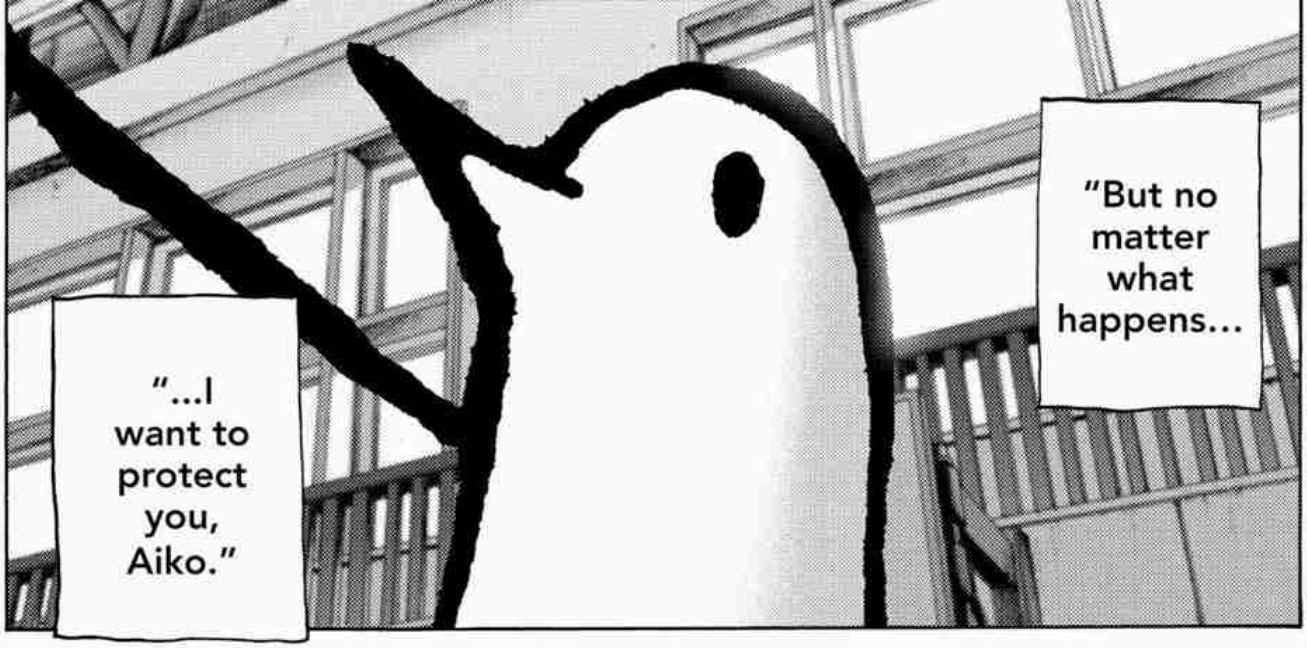
...over and over again.

One thing ran through Punpun's head...

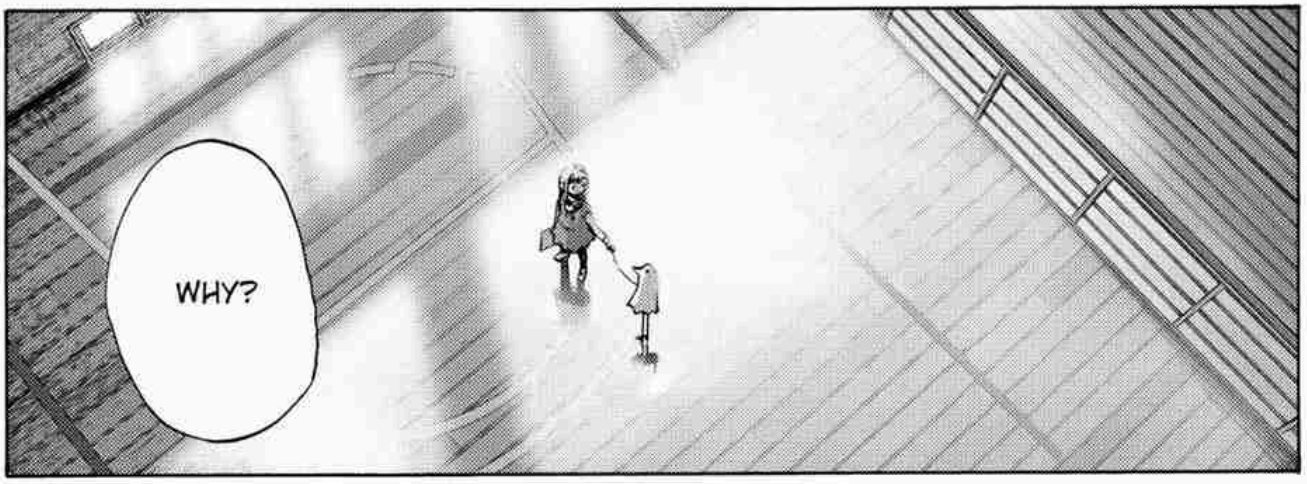


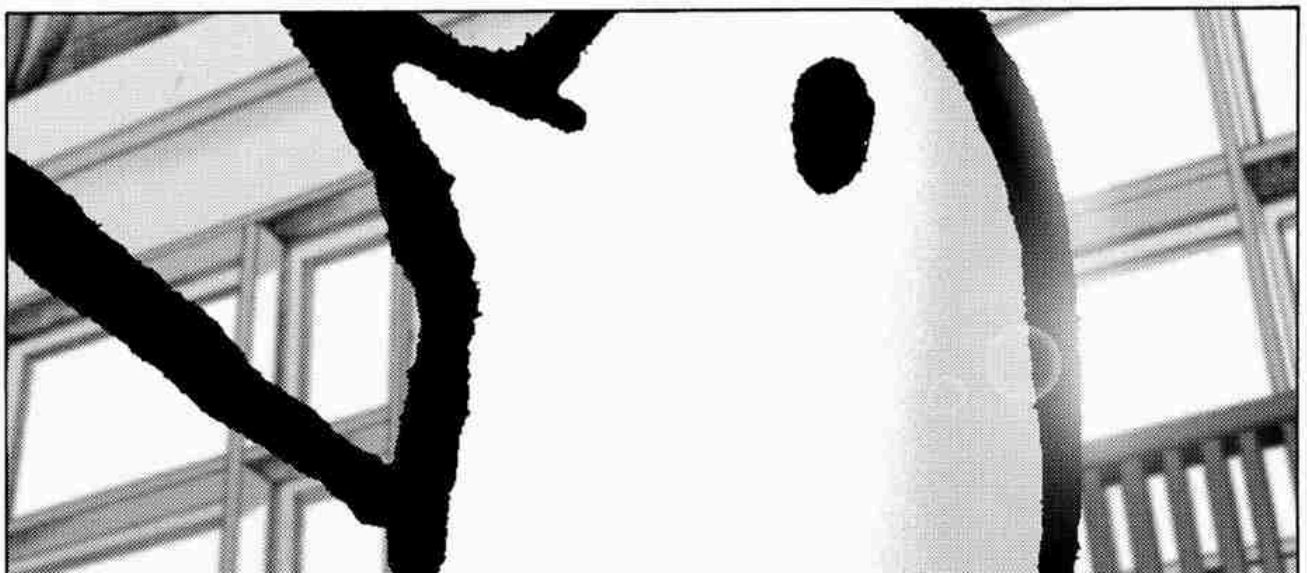

"I may not...
"...be able to save everyone from extinction..."


HMM?


"But no matter what happens...
"...I want to protect you, Aiko."

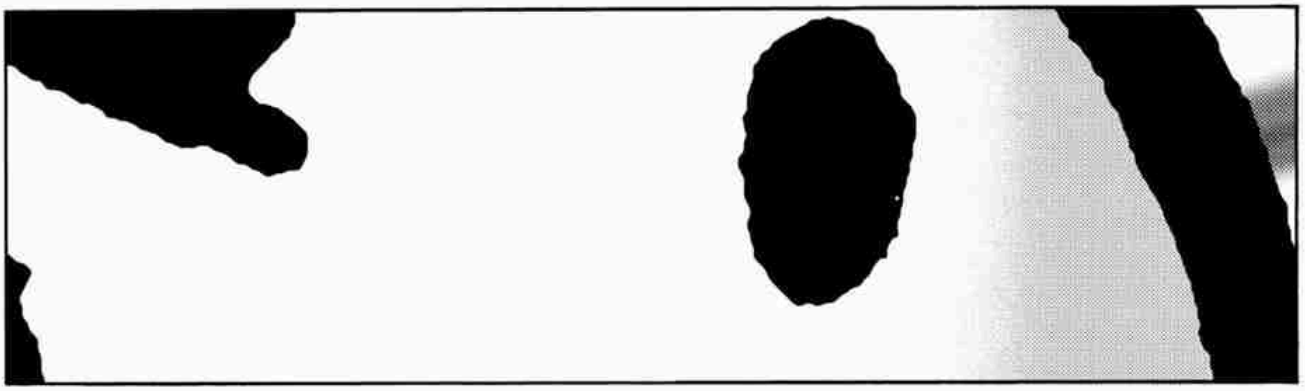


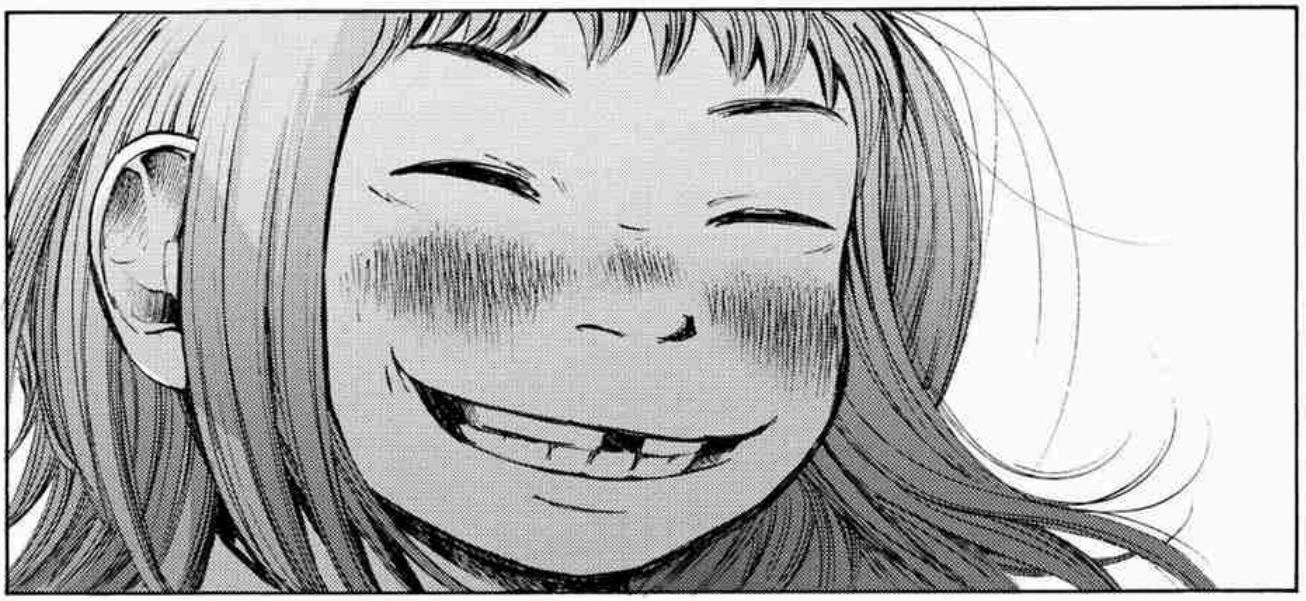

WHY?




"Because I love you."

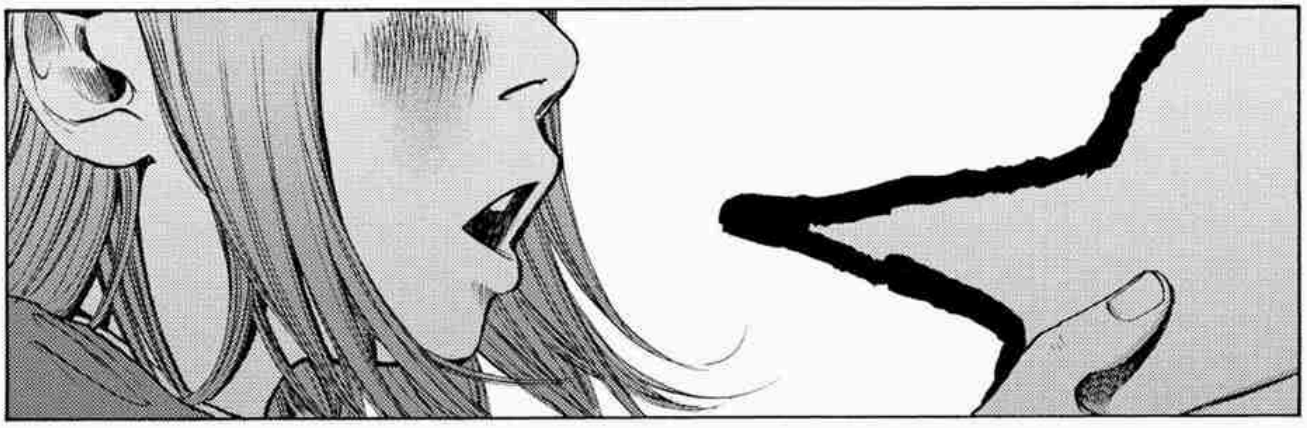


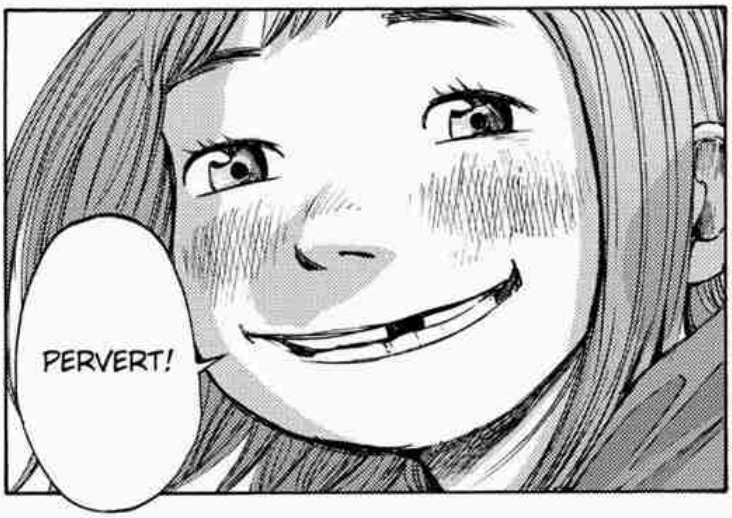


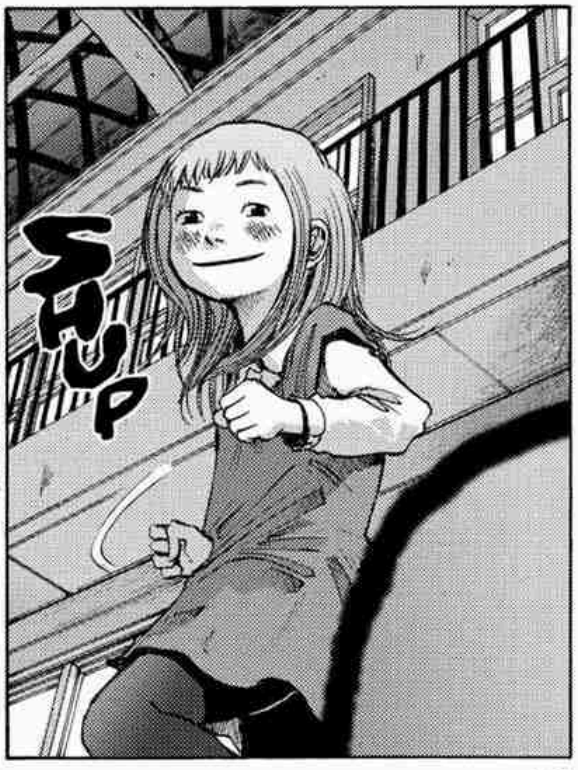


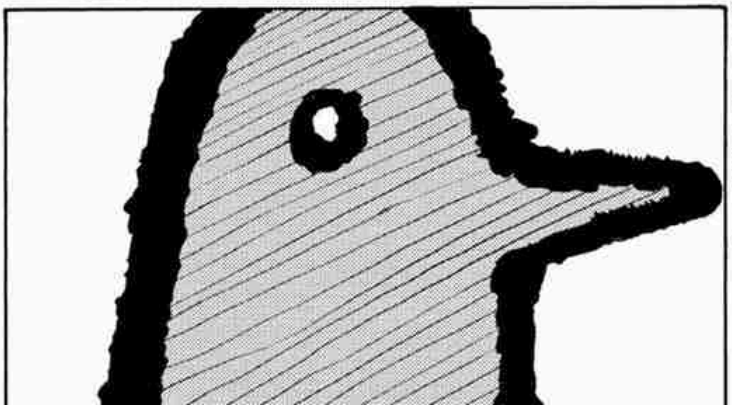


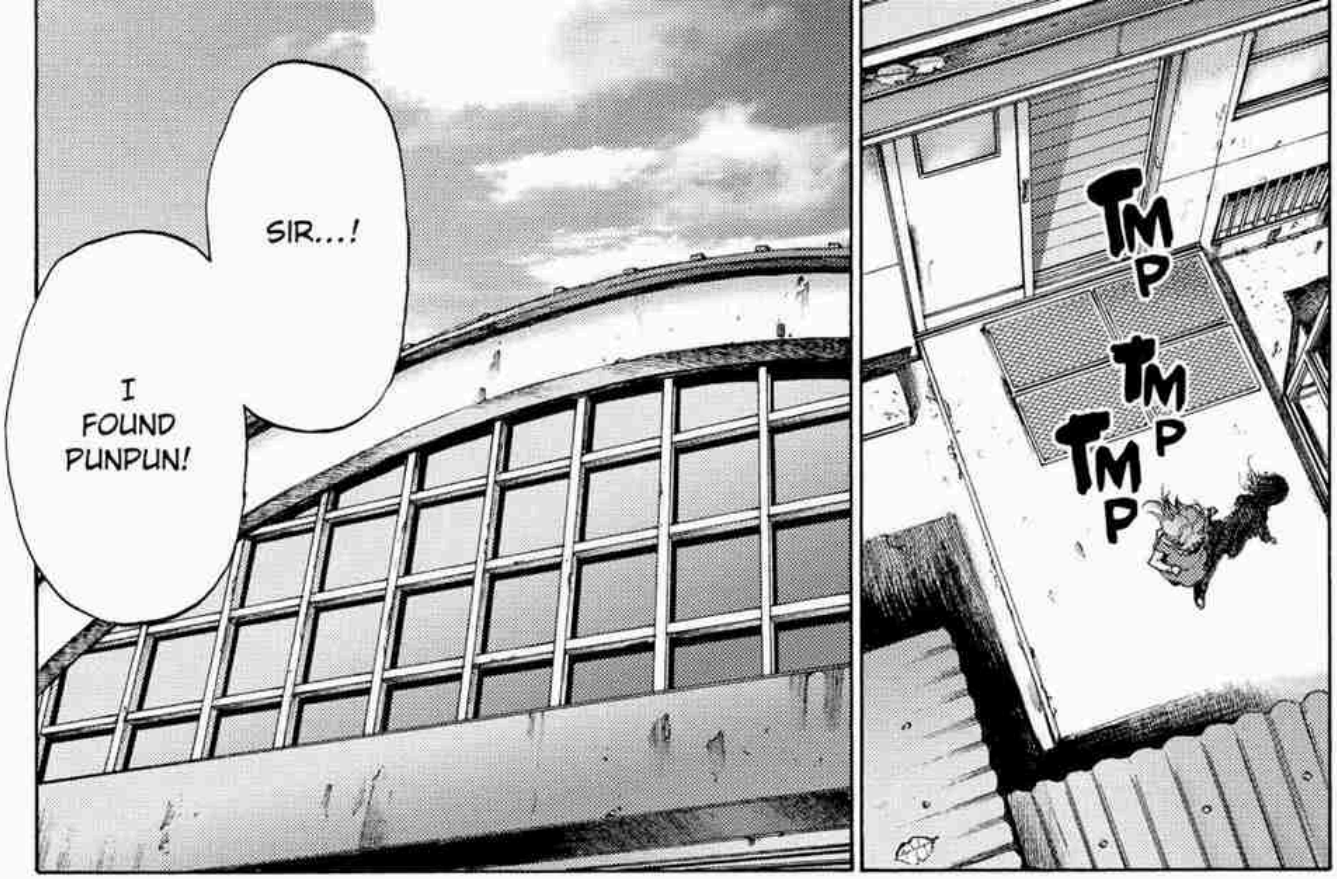


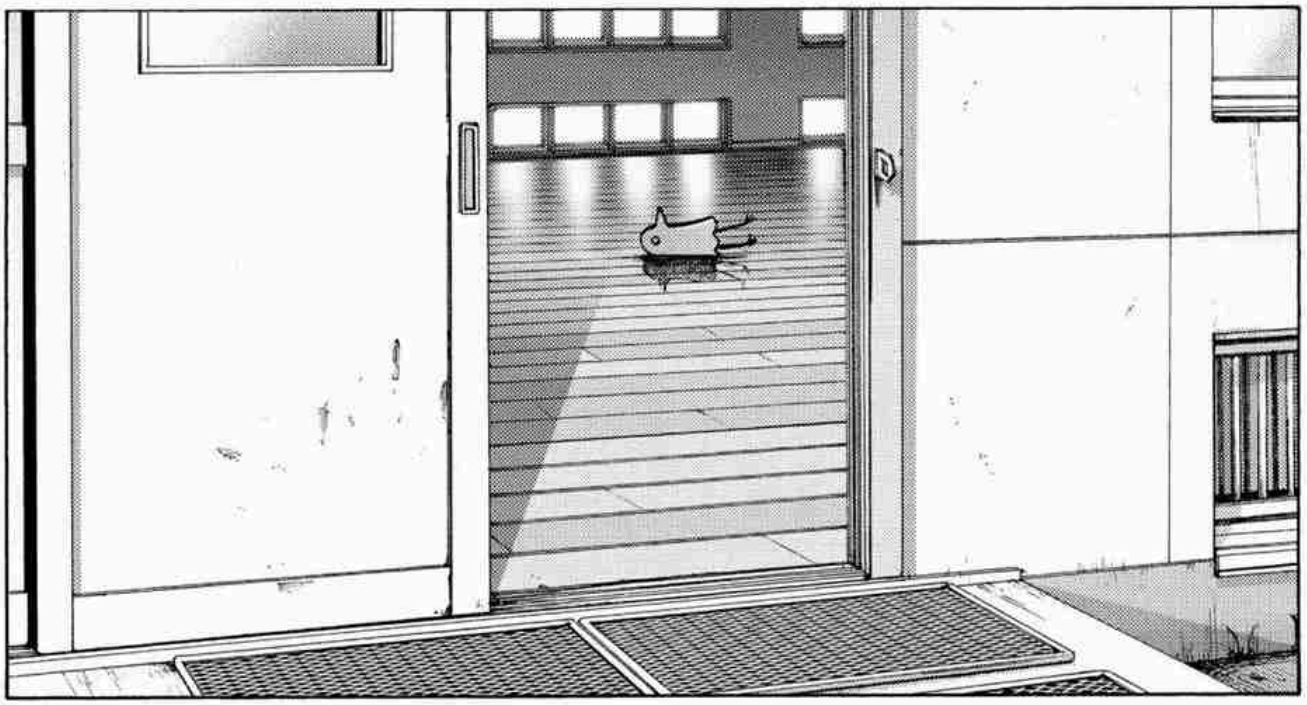



PERVERT!


SHUP




SIR...!
I FOUND PUNPUN!
TMP
TMP
TMP






If I had one wish

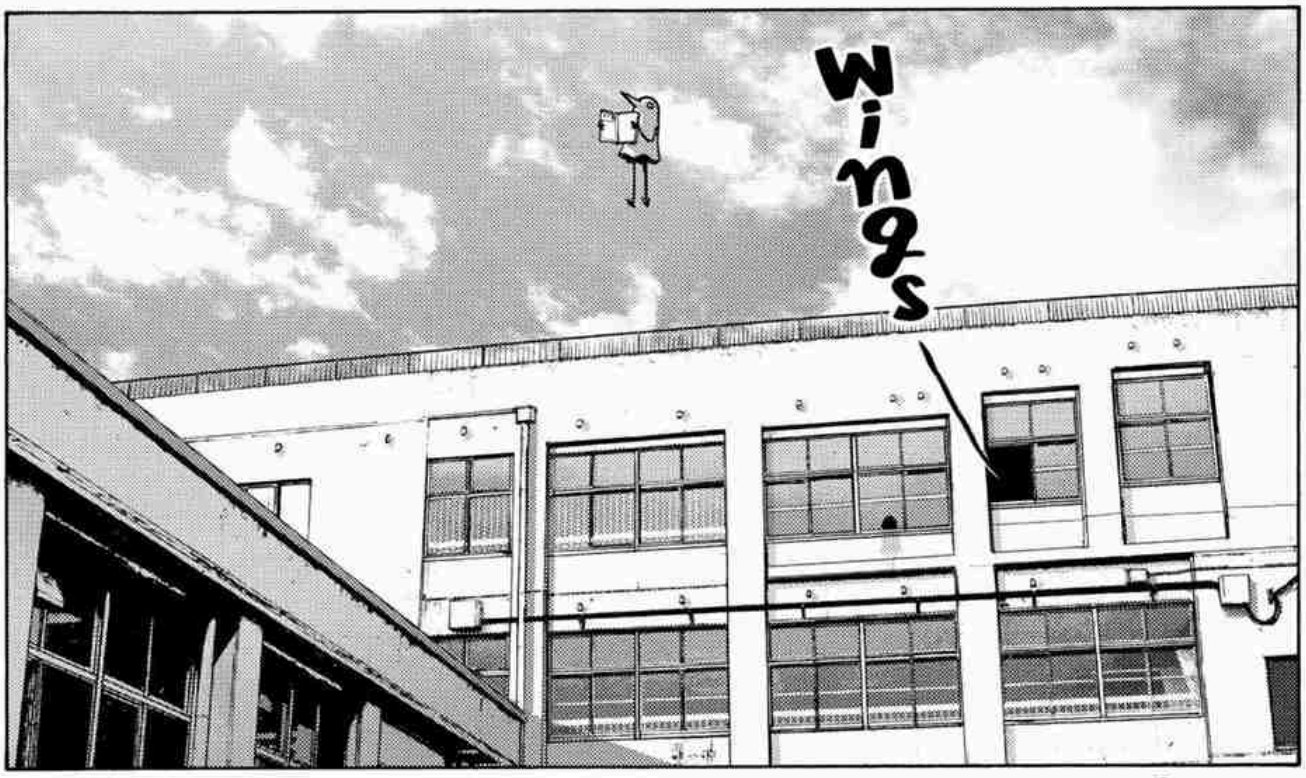

to
come
true
right
now

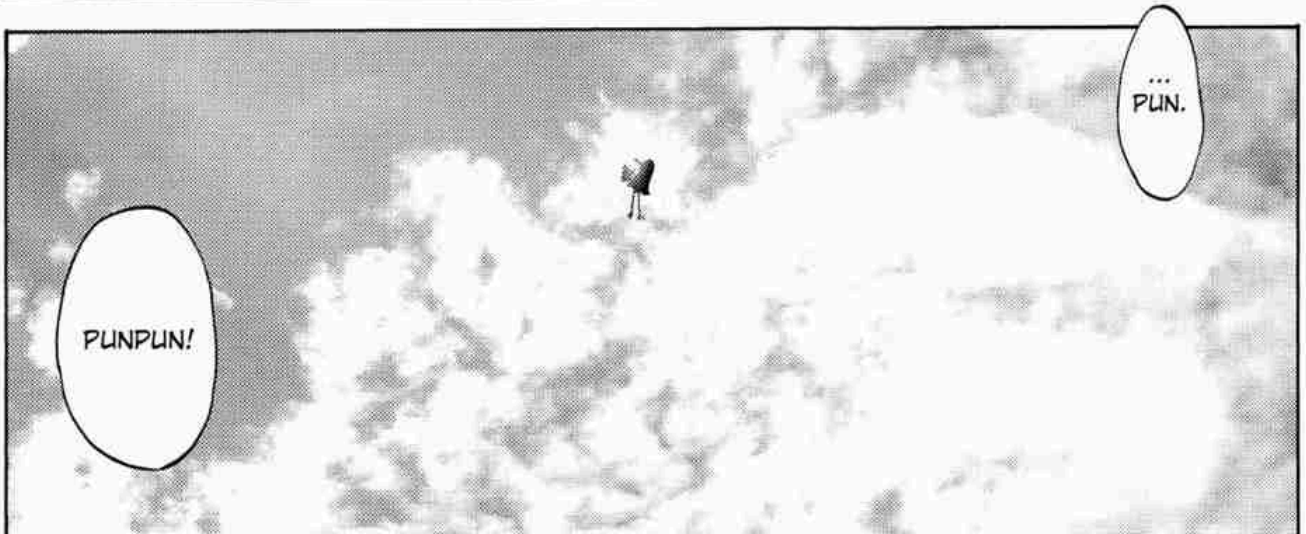

IF YOU DON'T PAY ATTENTION, I'LL PUT YOU IN A HEADLOCK!


Punpun couldn't bring himself to look at Aiko.
PUNPUN!
MUSIC


AHAHAHA


I'd wish for
His heart was beating so fast...
you to
give me
...he felt like he was going to fly away.


wings


... PUN.
PUNPUN!



*PWC=Porn Watchers' Club



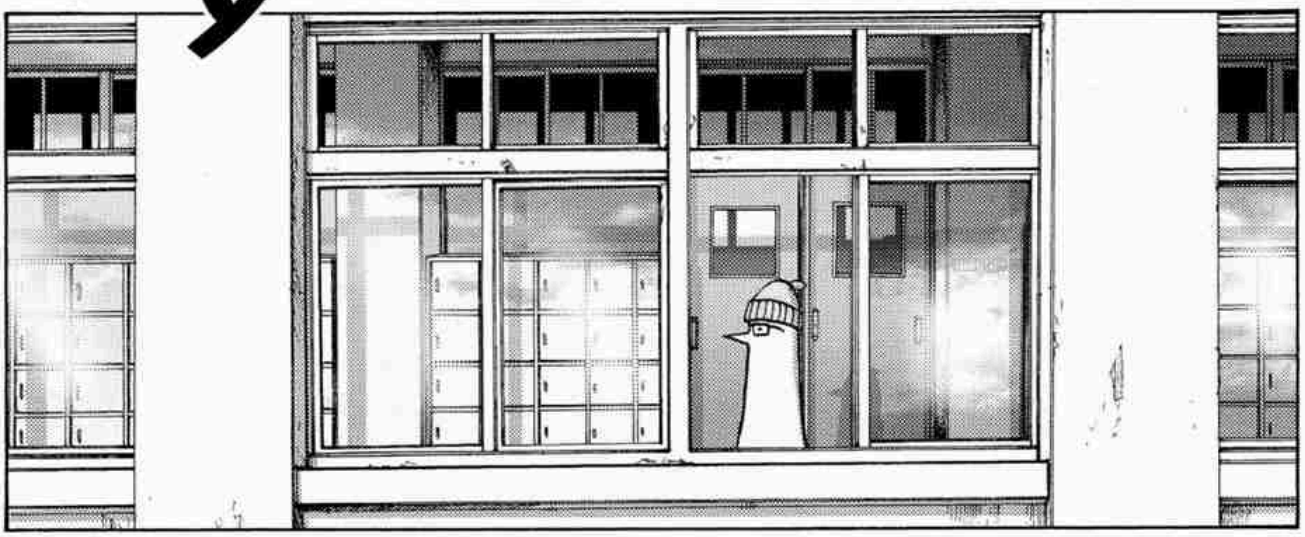

THANK YOU FOR STOPPING BY.
OH NO, THANK *YOU*.
WE ALL GO THROUGH HARDSHIPS.
IT'S THE ONE THING NO ONE CAN RUN AWAY FROM.


I want to

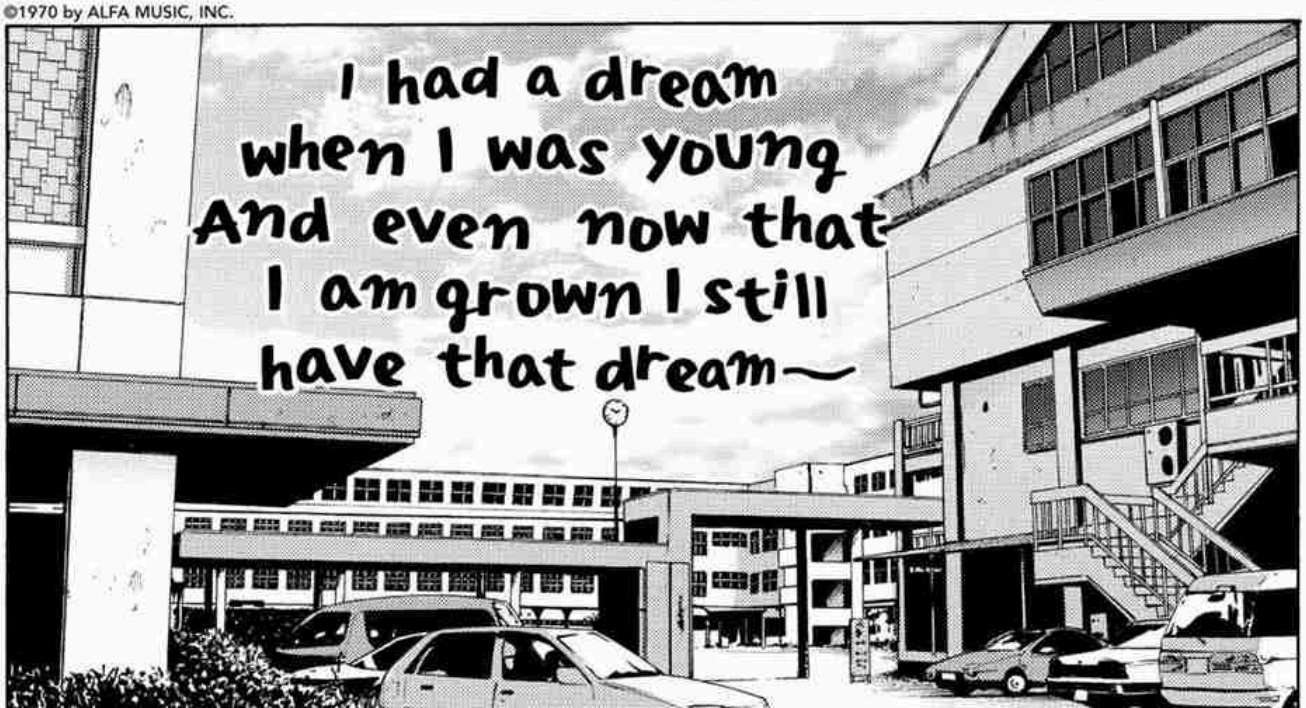

Spread my wings and fly far far away


Across the sky where no sadness dwells



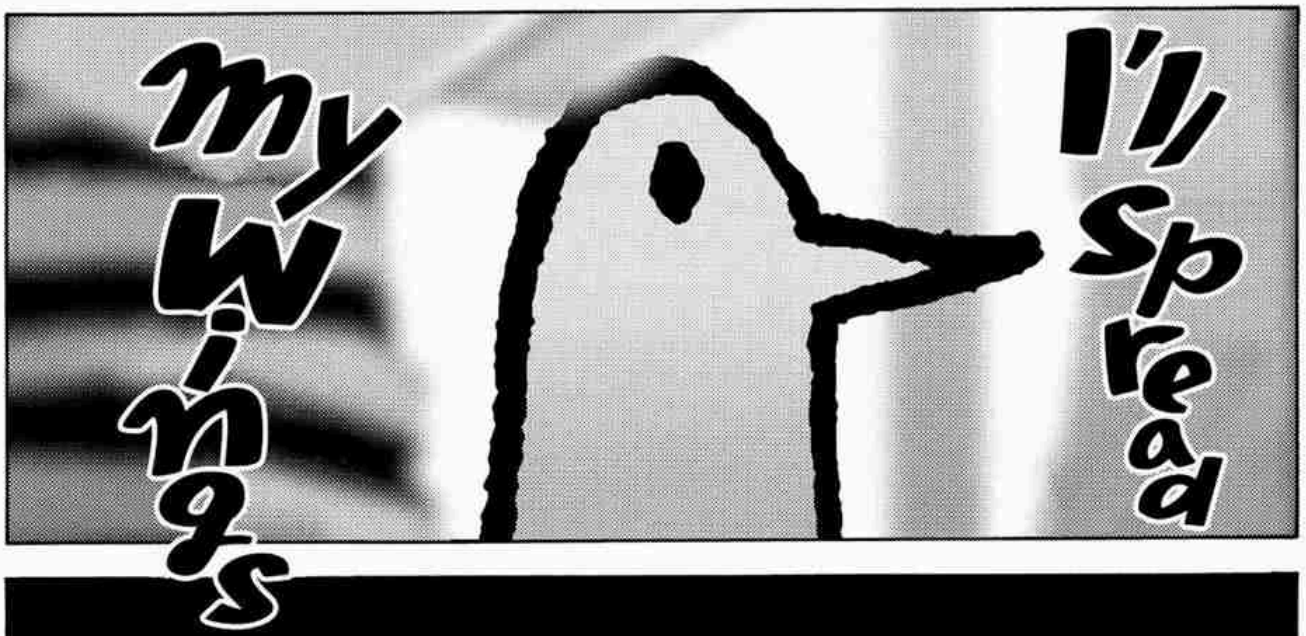


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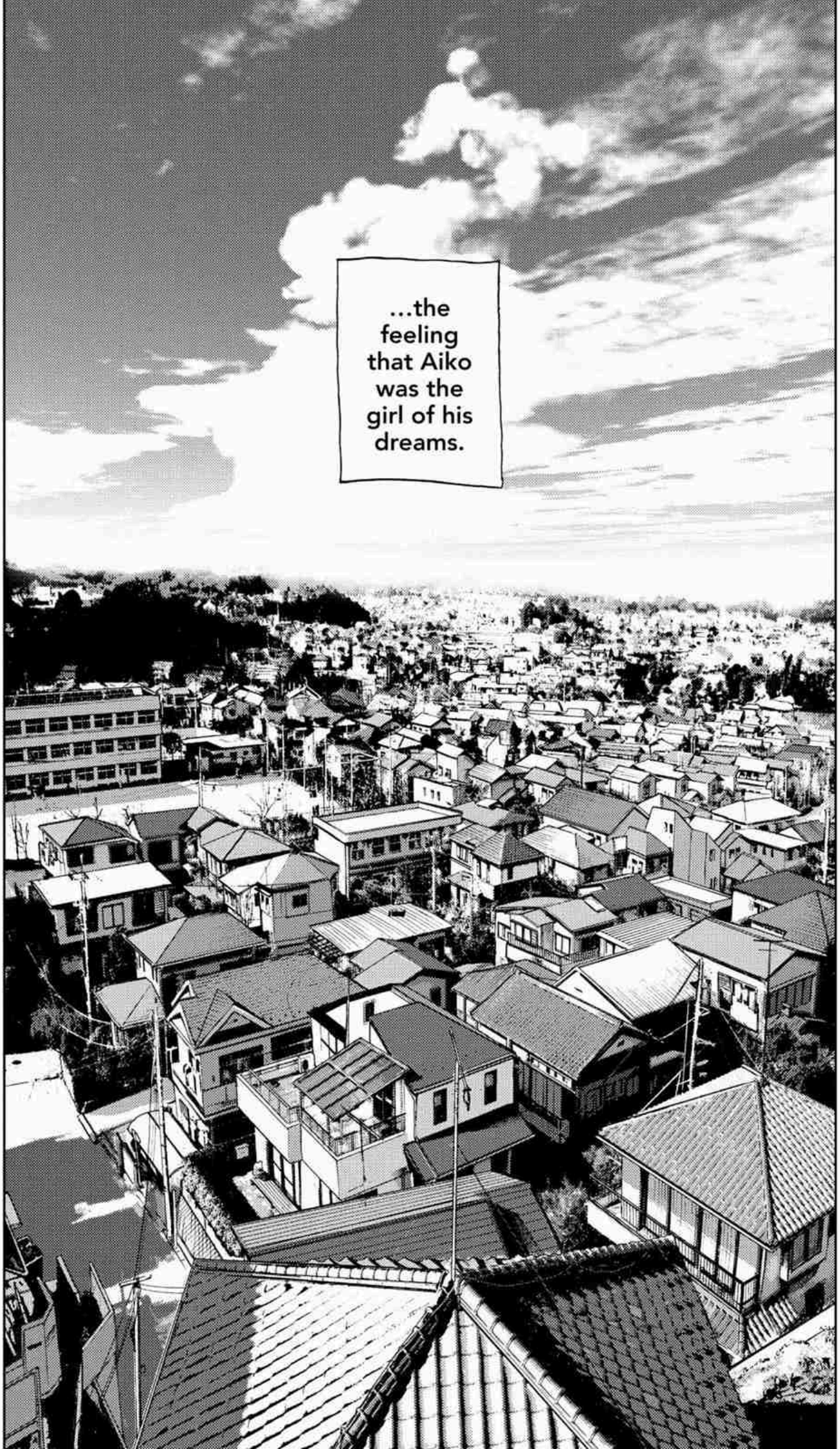


At that moment, Punpun was having a feeling he didn't quite understand.



He was still young, so this was the first time Punpun had ever experienced this particular feeling.

It was...


...the feeling that Aiko was the girl of his dreams.